



TECHNICAL REPORT

Senso Comune Gallery

Design, commerce and compliance

Unique paintings, sold from mainland China to buyers at home and abroad. What follows is what that costs, what it requires, and what is still unresolved.

Prepared for Priscilla

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Repository `senso-comune-gallery`

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PART 1

Summary

1.1 What this is

A site selling unique paintings — six in the catalogue at the time of writing, priced \$60–\$440 — run by one non-technical person resident in mainland China, addressed equally to international and domestic buyers.

That last sentence contains most of the difficulty. A gallery site for a handful of works is an afternoon’s work. A gallery site for a handful of works that takes money across the Chinese border, ships physical objects internationally, satisfies two consumer-law regimes at once and loads acceptably on both sides of the Great Firewall is not.

Nothing in the build is fixed to six. The counts, the series and the page set are all derived from the work data; adding a seventh work, or a new series, is a data edit.

1.2 Where things stand

Table 1: The site on 20 September 2026

Built	36 pages, 18 in each language: the homepage, the catalogue and its two series, six work pages, sold works, and seven pages of information
Published	A preview on GitHub Pages: not indexed, labelled on every page, and unable to take an order
Ready to sell	No. The readiness gate counts 57 details still owed (Section 5.5.4), and a release refuses to build until they are supplied
Checked	Five checks on every build, and a sixth in a real browser (Section 5.4)
Still to build	The buy box and disclosures on the work page; the cart, search and account behind the shop bar (Section 6.6)

1.3 The seven findings that would have sunk it

Table 2: Blocking findings, all now dealt with in the build

Finding	Where
Every call to action was #A19E97 — 2.67:1, failing both the body-text and the large-text floor. No font size rescues it.	Section 2.2

Finding	Where
Stripe is unavailable to a mainland-China seller — the whole account, not merely PayPal. Airwallex excludes mainland entities from card acquiring and opens no individual accounts at all.	Section 3.1
<code>vercel.app</code> and <code>workers.dev</code> measure 100% blocked from mainland China. <code>pages.dev</code> measures 0%.	Section 1.4
A unique pre-existing painting gets no returns exception under either Chinese or EU law. Uniqueness is not personalisation.	Section 4.1
Instagram was the only contact channel. It is blocked in mainland China, and EU law requires an email address regardless.	Section 4.2
China-origin paintings are not duty-free into the United States. Section 301 adds 7.5% and the \$800 de minimis exemption is suspended.	Section 3.3
A one-page site cannot link to one painting, which is the site's main acquisition motion.	Section 2.7

1.4 Decisions taken

Settled

Launch as an individual, with the Hong Kong entity reachable as a configuration change rather than a rebuild. Under CNY 100,000 annual turnover there is no business-registration requirement, no foreign-exchange quota consumed, no balance-of-payments filing and no VAT.

Host on Cloudflare Pages. The only option with no bill, no pause, no terms problem and no ICP filing.

A page for everything that is shared. Every work, series and policy has its own address in both languages; two lines of CSS (`@view-transition`) keep the calm of a single page when moving between them.

Self-host the fonts. 81.7 KB for both families, built from the variable originals, plus 31.3 KB of italic that is fetched only where an italic is set.

Adopt Priscilla's sage palette — all of it. The walls are her sage, held at a lightness that can carry prose; cream is kept for the mat around a painting and paints no page surface (Section 2.2.2).

1.5 Cost

Table 3: Running cost of the recommended build

Item	One-off	Annual
Hosting (Cloudflare Pages)	\$0	\$0
Domain (registrar at cost)	—	\$11

Item	One-off	Annual
Fonts, licensing (SIL OFL)	\$0	\$0
Analytics	\$0	\$0
Photography, phone build	\$6-25	—
Photography, full build	\$360-400	—
Copyright registration, batch	\$85	—
Total, minimum viable	\$6-25	\$11

Payment processing is separate and depends on the entity decision; see Section 3.1.

PART 2

Design

2.1 Where the design came from

Priscilla supplied a nine-page draft and, later, a live mockup with a revised palette. Both were treated as the brief. The work here was not to redesign but to find where the drawing and the medium disagree — and they disagreed mostly about contrast.

2.2 The palette

Priscilla's mockup moves the site from white to a sage-green world: a dark brown mast-head bar, warm brown text, terracotta, and cream plates behind the paintings. Two of her decisions were already right and are kept exactly as drawn — the warm browns, and a **filled** terracotta button.

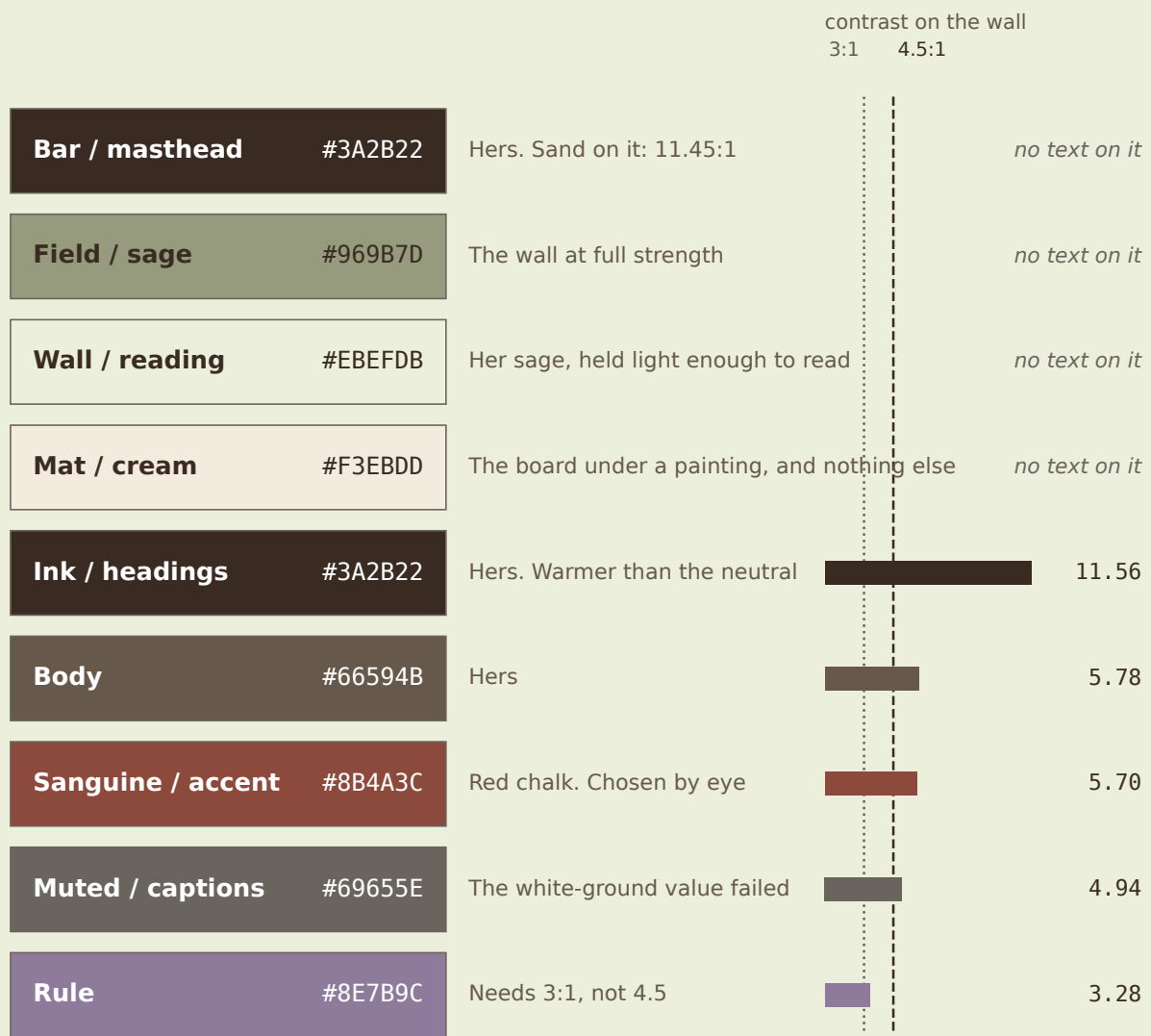


Figure 1: The palette as built. Each value is read from the project’s token file, not transcribed.

2.2.1 What could not be adopted as drawn

Body text on the sage does not pass, and the accent on sage is worse than the value it was replacing.

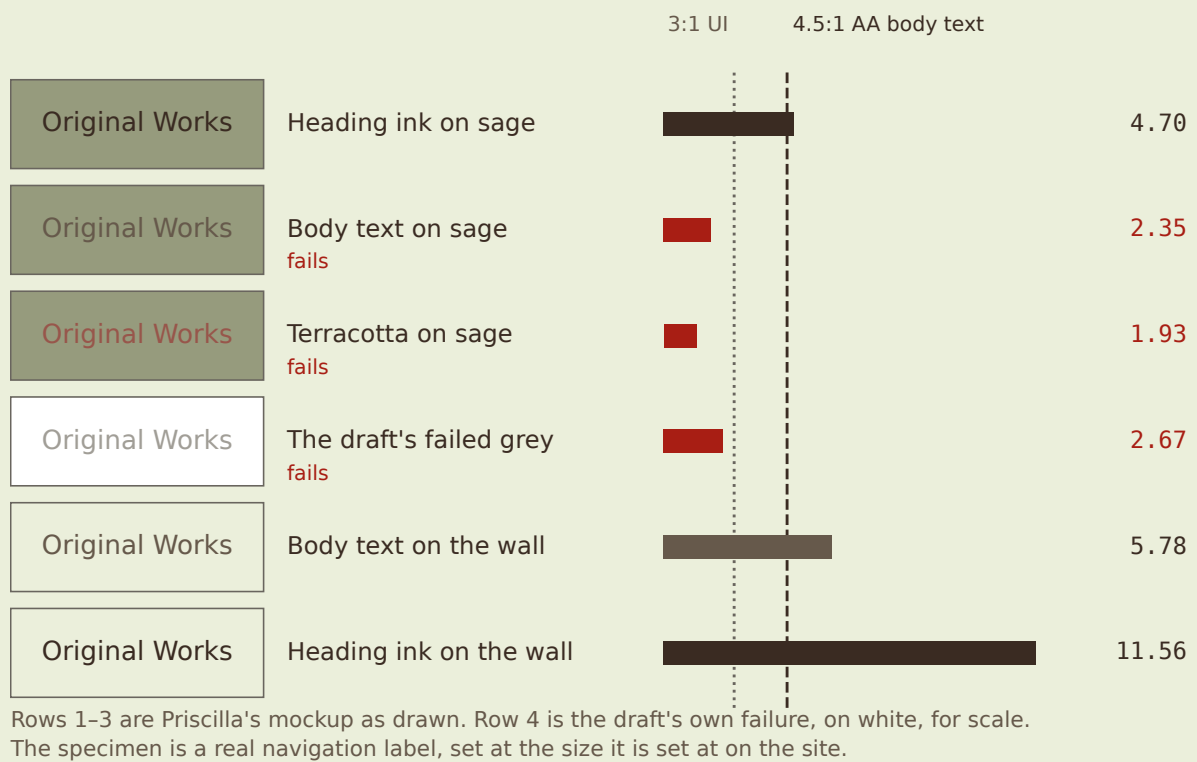


Figure 2: Why the sage carries no text. The three red bars are Priscilla’s mockup as drawn; the draft’s original failure is included for scale.

The resolution was already in her own mockup

She sets the paintings on light cream plates against the sage. So sage becomes the **field** and a light plate the **reading surface** — the whole content column is a sheet mounted on sage, which is what a gallery does to a work on paper anyway.
Her green stays dominant at the margins, and nothing sets text on the field.

That sheet was cream for the first three months of the project. It is sage now, and the cream has gone back to being the mat: Section 2.2.2.

2.2.2 Sage as the reading ground

Decision of 20 September 2026, and the research behind it.

The brief for this pass was one line: restrict cream to the backgrounds of the art pieces, and put everything else on sage and its variations. That is a bigger request than it sounds, because Section 2.2.1 is the reason the reading was on cream in the first place — her sage measures 2.35:1 under body text.

So the first question is not *which* sage but **what the failure was actually about**. It is answerable by measurement rather than by taste. Solving every foreground the site sets on a reading surface — nine of them, at their own floors — over a grid of candidate grounds in the plane of the field’s own hue gives Figure 3, and the finding is the shape of the boundary:

The line is **flat**. A reading ground fails on **lightness** and on nothing else. Below L^* 91.5 the binding pair is `--muted-ui` at 3.0:1 — an icon stroke, not prose — and above it, **chroma is free**: a ground can carry the field's full chroma of 0.043 and `--muted-ui` still measures 3.05:1.

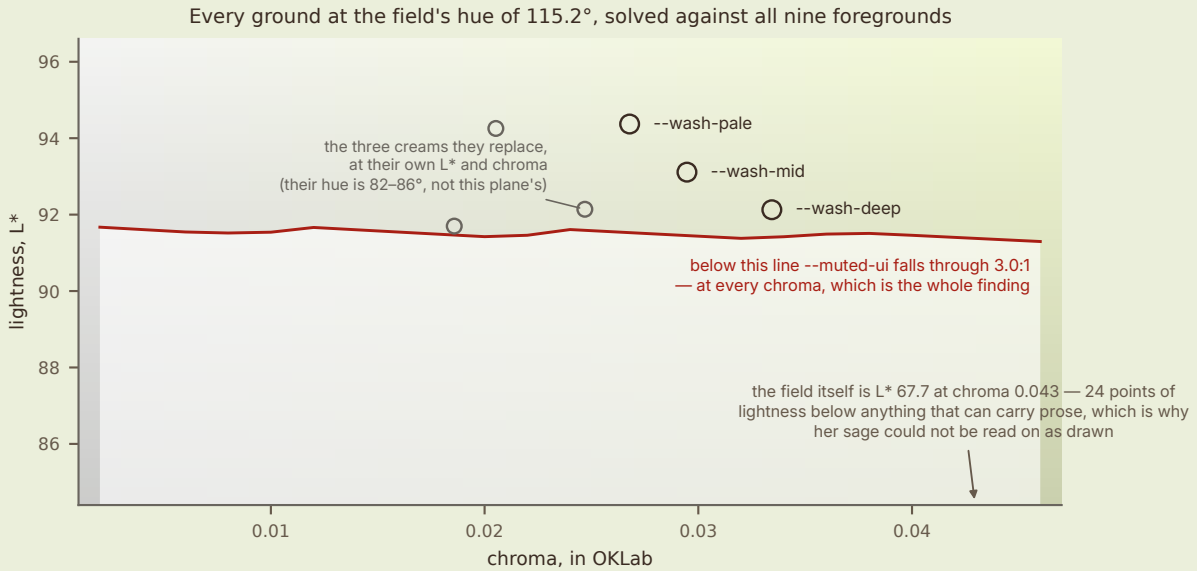


Figure 3: Where a reading ground may live. Every cell is a real colour at the field's hue; the veiled region is what `check-contrast.mjs` refuses.

Which makes the move obvious and cheap: **keep the lightness ladder that was already measured safe, and rotate its chroma onto the field's hue**. The three grounds do not move up or down, so not one of the ~60 pairs the contrast check solves had to be re-solved. They are better than they were:

Table 4: The three reading grounds, before and after. Not one foreground token moved.

Ground	Was	Now	<code>--muted-ui</code> on it	<code>--body</code> on it
<code>--wash-pale</code> (the sheet, Works)	#F3EBDD cream	#EBEFDB	3.24 → 3.27	5.73 → 5.78
<code>--wash-mid</code> (Tribute)	#EDE4D3 cream	#E7EBD5	3.04 → 3.15	5.38 → 5.57
<code>--wash-deep</code> (About)	#E9E3D6 cream	#E4E8CF	3.00 → 3.06	5.31 → 5.41

The old names — warm, violet, blue — were inherited from washes that had been gone for months; all three were cream. They are now named for the only thing that separates them, which is lightness.

Then where does cream go? It keeps the job it was drawn for in her mockup and gives up the one the build invented for it. Cream paints:

- the **mat** around every painting, and the same mat around the video and the thumbnails — a board is a different material from a wall, and one step of hue is what says so: against --wash-deep the mat is dE 1.8 in OKLab, a boundary you can see and cannot name;
- the box that holds an image before its bytes arrive;
- **light ink on the dark bar** — the wordmark, the navigation, the 12 % wash under a hovered control;
- the focus halo, which has to survive being drawn over a dark painting.

It paints no ground that anyone reads on. `check-review.mjs` L-01 holds that by listing every rule allowed to paint cream — fifteen of them — and failing on a sixteenth, so adding one is a decision rather than a slip.

One new token came out of it. The frosted plate behind the contact panel was --paper at 72 %, which on the palest ground made it *the same colour as the thing it was laid on*. It is now --wash-lift, one step lighter than every ground, so the plate is visible on all three and still cannot darken what is read on it.

2.2.3 The warm-ground trap

#767676 is the canonical “lightest grey that passes on white”. On pure white it passes at 4.54:1, with 0.04 to spare. Warm the ground at all and it fails.

This caught the project three times — twice in tokens written specifically to avoid it. The response was to stop checking by eye: `scripts/check-contrast.mjs` recomputes every token against **the darkest ground it is ever painted on** and fails the build on a regression.

2.3 Typography

Two open-source variable faces, self-hosted: Fraunces and Inter.

Table 5: Font build, measured rather than estimated

Build	Bytes
Fraunces, all four axes	121,124
Fraunces, opsz 14–40, wght 400–700, WONK 1	51,868
Fraunces, opsz pinned	32,500
Fraunces, SOFT axis kept live	91,304
Inter, opsz 18, wght 400–600	29,856
Total, both families, latin subset	81,724
Fraunces Italic, opsz 14–30, wght 400 — not preloaded	32,080
Fraunces Italic, wght 400–700	58,344

Two corrections came out of running the build rather than reading about it. The draft sets Fraunces at six optical sizes — 16.0, 16.8, 21.6, 27.2, 30.4 and 38.4 — so the opsz axis must stay live; pinning it saves 19 KB and flattens the optical sizing the design depends on. And Fraunces’ WONK axis defaults to **1, not 0**; pinning it to 0 changes the letterforms to save 140 bytes.

2.3.1 The italic the site was faking

The site sets italic in four places — the hero's Dutch original, the Tribute epigraph, and every work title, both in the list and as an `h1` — and shipped no italic file, so the browser slanted the roman by 12° in all four. A synthetic oblique of a high-contrast serif is a poor imitation of a drawing that already exists: Fraunces' italic is a different letter, not a tilted one, with a single-storey *a*, a cursive *e* and a -16° angle the letterforms were made for.

It is now a real file, and the axes are narrowed harder than the roman's because its uses are known exactly: `opsz 14–30` covers every size an italic is actually set at, and one weight, because no italic on this site is bold. That is **32,080 bytes**; keeping 400–700 would have been 58,344 for nothing. It is deliberately *not* preloaded — nothing above the fold waits on it — and `font-synthesis-style: none` now says the browser may not invent the style anywhere else either, including for the Chinese face, which has no italic and should not be given a slanted one.

2.3.2 About, set as a book page

About is the only page on the site that is nothing but prose. It was set in the interface face, at interface size, in a column the same shape as How to Buy — a form with an essay in it.

The first question was whether it needed a new typeface, and the answer is on the record with numbers rather than as a preference:

- **A third family** was rejected on the same grounds as Section 2.3: every render-blocking file is another thing to go wrong in a Chinese TCP handshake.
- **Fraunces' SOFT axis**, kept live, would soften the terminals — and take the roman from 51,868 to **91,304 bytes**, +76 % on a preloaded file, for one page's worth of prettiness.
- **Old-style figures and small caps** were the obvious next reach, and Fraunces simply has neither: its whole `GSUB` is `case, liga, rvrn, ss01`. So "10 %" is set in the lining figures the face draws, and nothing is faked.

What the page is set in, then, is the face the site already preloads — at the one size where that face is the same **reading size** as the sans it replaces. That size is not a matter of judgement either. Measured off the shipped subsets, at their own optical sizes:

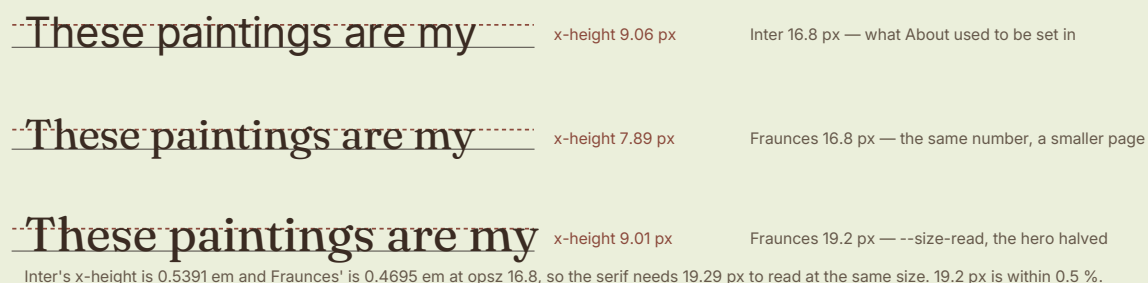


Figure 4: Why 19.2 px. A serif set at the sans's point size makes a page of prose quietly smaller; x-height is what a reader sees.

19.2 px is also where the type scale already put it — the hero halved (Table 6) — so the page gains a reading size without inventing a step.

Four moves, three of which cost nothing to download: the display face at `--size-read` with `opsize` tied to it; a **lede**, the first paragraph at `--size-mark` in `--ink`, so the page opens with a voice; a **drop cap** of three lines in sanguine, behind an `@supports (initial-letter: 3)` test so it simply does not happen where the property is unsupported; and the van Gogh quotation that closes the page set in the **real italic**, which `build.js` marks by wrapping the quoted span.

Two details are about the Chinese page, and both are refusals. It gets no drop cap and no italic, because neither is a Chinese typographic device and both would be synthesised. And it is **not** set in `--font-display`: that stack begins with the subset Noto Serif SC, which carries only the ~100 CJK glyphs that appear in display positions, so a page of Chinese prose set in it would render some characters in Noto and the rest in the system face — one paragraph, two typefaces. `--font-read-cjk` is a stack of system serifs instead, so the Chinese About page gets a book face for nothing, and gets it consistently.

2.3.3 The scale

Not the golden ratio. The one proportional system in Leonardo's own hand, on the *Vitruvian Man* sheet, is whole-number fractions of height.

Table 6: Type scale, and how close Priscilla's draft already was

Role	Fraction	Computed	Draft used
Hero	1 (the height)	38.4 px	38.4 px
Section heading	less 1/8	33.6 px	30.4 px
Sub-heading	less 1/4	28.8 px	27.2 px
Wordmark	1/6 + 1/4	22.4 px	21.6 px
Body	the unit	16.8 px	16.8 px
Caption	less 1/4	12.6 px	13.1 px

2.4 The mark

The site had a wordmark and no mark. On a business whose entire acquisition motion is a link in an Instagram or a WeChat bio, the surfaces that render most often are a browser tab, a share card and an avatar — and none of them can render a wordmark.

The mark it now carries is Priscilla's own: an interlocking **SC** monogram, drawn, with a prototype sheet that arrives with a construction, a palette, four variations and a minimum size already worked out. **The site uses that artwork itself** — her drawing, cropped and resized, never redrawn.

2.4.1 The constraint that used to decide it

The wordmark translates: *Senso Comune Gallery* in English, 常识画廊 in Chinese. A fav-
icon, by contrast, is chosen by **origin**, not by page: one file serves both URL trees, so a
site cannot ship one mark per locale however much it would like to.

The first mark took that to its conclusion and carried no letterforms at all — a work on a
wall, three rectangles and a hanging line — on the argument that SC is not the initials of 常
识画廊 and would therefore serve one audience and decorate the other.

Why that argument no longer holds

Finding C-04 asked for the Latin wordmark to be kept constant in both locales, and
was **closed by decision**: Priscilla keeps 常识画廊 as the Chinese name, because it
reads as native to the domestic audience and that is worth more than one lockup in
two languages.

That decision is what frees the mark. A monogram is not a translation of a name —
it is a *device* that stands beside one, and a device does not have to be readable as
the name it accompanies any more than a crest does. The Latin device beside the
Chinese name is the arrangement most international houses use in China. What is not
allowed is a mark that says a *different* name in each locale, and the build asserts that
the lockup is byte-identical on the English and Chinese homepages.

2.4.2 The sheet, as drawn



Figure 5: The prototype sheet, reproduced as supplied — brand/brand-sheet .png.

Construction and proportion, the hatching detail, the four variations, clear space and minimum size, the four brand colours, and the horizontal and vertical lockups.



Figure 6: The preferred option, reproduced as supplied — brand/mark-lockup.png.

This is the artwork the site uses: the monogram with its construction lines, over the word-mark. Everything the build ships is a crop and a resize of this one file.

Both files live in `brand/`, unmodified, and are pinned by hash: re-exporting or tidying either one fails the build and has to be a decision rather than an accident. They arrived at `dist/archive/logo/`, which is build output and is gitignored, so keeping them meant moving them somewhere the repository keeps.

2.4.3 The notes on the sheet, and what each one costs

Every row's left column is the sheet's own wording. The right column is what it means once the mark has to live in a browser tab, on a phone masthead and in this document.

Table 7: The sheet's specification, and the issue against each

As the sheet states it	What it costs, and what was done
Golden Ratio 1 : 1.618	Adopted as drawn — the artwork <i>is</i> the construction, so nothing has to be re-derived. The number only became a question when the mark was being rebuilt rather than used; see Section 2.4.5
Letter Proportion S : C = 1 : 1.618	As above. Taken literally in a <i>rebuild</i> it makes the S fall to about the C's x-height; in Priscilla's own drawing the S is visibly larger than 1/1.618 of the C, which is why the drawing reads and a literal reconstruction did not
Grid System based on Fibonacci Spiral & Golden Rectangle	Visible in the artwork as construction lines, and they are part of the drawing, not scaffolding to be cleaned off. They are also the first thing to disappear as the file gets smaller — by 32 px they are grey haze (Figure 8)
Diagonal Hatching, Upper Left → Lower Right	The same direction and angle as the Leonardo hatch already running across the Tribute ground (base.css, .hatch) — an agreement nobody arranged, and worth keeping
Subtle texture / Enhances depth and form / Not overpowering	True at the sizes the sheet is drawn for. At 32 px the hatching has become tone rather than texture, and at 16 px it is a smudge. Nothing in the build can fix that; it is stated instead (Section 2.4.4)
Primary (Sage Green) #969B7D Black (For Print / Digital) #24241F	Already --field, exactly Not adopted as a site colour. The site's ink and bar are #3A2B22, a warm brown the whole palette is solved against; a cool near-black beside sage reads as a second, colder identity. It is kept for print, where it is what the sheet says
Reversed (Dark Background)	The variation that would suit the masthead best — and it is a <i>different drawing</i> from the preferred one: solid letters, no construction lines. Not used, because the instruction was to use the preferred option. The site instead lets the artwork's own cream paper be the plate, which is the site's own device
Monochrome (One Color)	Held in reserve for single-ink reproduction, where the hatching and the letter cannot be separated by lightness at all
Deep Green #737C61	Already --field-deep, exactly

As the sheet states it	What it costs, and what was done
Warm Ivory #E9E2D3	Not added. It was within one step of what was then --wash-blue #E9E3D6, and a fifth cream is a fifth cream. The reading grounds have since gone sage and the creams with them; the artwork's own paper measures #E4DCCC and is kept as it is
Clear Space & Minimum Size — 15 mm (Print)	The icon build uses the sheet's clear-space rule as its crop, at 5.5 % of the monogram's side. The minimum size is the sheet's for print; the screen equivalents are in Section 2.4.4, and they are smaller than 15 mm
Horizontal lockup / Vertical lockup	Both are on the sheet and neither is used yet. The site's masthead is its own lockup — the mark beside a wordmark already set in Fraunces — and the two supplied lockups set the name in a different face
"Art connects what we share"	A line, not a tagline in use. It is not on the site, and nothing here proposes putting it there
"Timeless / Art Gallery / Identity"	The sheet's own note on intent. Recorded, and it is the right description

2.4.4 The issues, one by one

Four of these are worth more than a table row. None is a reason not to use the artwork; all four are reasons to know what using it costs.

1 — There is no vector, and the raster is 1536 × 1024. That is the whole supply. The monogram occupies about 590 px of it, which is enough for a 180 px home-screen icon and a masthead mark at 2× on a phone, and is the ceiling. A business card, a 15 mm foil stamp or a gallery window would each want the original vector or a much larger scan. **Ask for the source file** — it exists somewhere, and it costs nothing to keep with the rest.

2 — A drawn mark does not survive 16 px. Figure 8 shows the same crop of the same file at each size that ships. At 180 px it is the drawing; at 32 px the construction lines have gone to haze and the hatching to tone; at 16 px what is left is a shape that reads as *a monogram* rather than as an S and a C. That is the size a browser tab uses on a standard display. The sheet's own answer to this is on the sheet — the **Monochrome** and **Reversed** variations (Figure 7), which are solid-lettered drawings without construction lines and would hold at 16 px. Switching the small sizes to one of them is a one-line change in `scripts/build-icons.py`; it is not made here, because the instruction was to use the preferred option as it is.



Figure 7: The variations panel, enlarged from Figure 5. These are a *different drawing* from the preferred option — solid letters, no construction lines — and they are what the sheet offers for the sizes and grounds the preferred one cannot hold.

3 — The mark is now a photograph of paper, not a shape. It cannot take `currentColor`, cannot invert for a dark theme, cannot be recoloured for a seasonal card, and cannot be knocked out of a coloured ground. The site works with that rather than against it: the artwork is opaque cream, so on the dark masthead it arrives as a small mounted plate — a cream sheet on a dark ground, which is the site's central visual idea at wordmark size.

4 — The SVG favicon is gone. The site shipped an `icon.svg`; a vector favicon is sharp at every size and is what a tab would rather have. There is no vector of this mark to ship, and an SVG wrapping a raster would be the same pixels behind a vector's promise. The set is now a 32 px PNG, the `.ico`, the 180 px home-screen icon and the manifest, all cut from the artwork by the icon build.

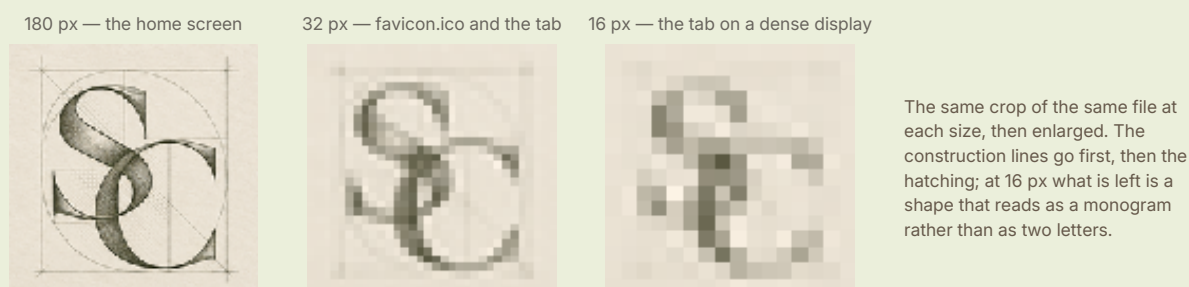


Figure 8: The adopted artwork at the three sizes the build cuts, each enlarged from the file that actually ships.

2.4.5 What was built before the artwork arrived

This is kept on the record, not as a second live logo. Between the decision to use a monogram and the arrival of the drawing, the site carried an SC **constructed** from Fraunces — the face the wordmark is already set in — with the outlines cut from the font at `opsize 40, weight 700` by `scripts/build-mark-paths.py`. `scripts/mark.mjs` still holds it, and the build

asserts that nothing the *site* builds imports it: it exists so that Figure 9 can be drawn, and for no other reason.

Two things it settled are still worth having.

The first is a **proportion**. Drawn at the sheet's literal 1 : 1.618 in a square field, Fraunces' S falls to about the C's x-height and stops reading as a capital — the mark reads sC — and the C's lower arm cannot reach far enough left to close the hole the small S leaves. The construction used $1 : \sqrt{\varphi} = 1 : 1.272$ instead, the same construction one step in. It is not a correction to the sheet: measured off Priscilla's own drawing, her S is nearer 1 : 1.3 of her C than 1 : 1.618, so what the reconstruction found was that the *stated* ratio and the *drawn* ratio are not the same number. The drawn one is the one that reads.

The second is the **size rule**: hatching comes off below about 96 px, because below that it fills in. The construction could obey it, by simply not drawing the hatch at small sizes. The artwork cannot, because the hatching is in the pixels — which is issue 2 above, arrived at twice from opposite directions.

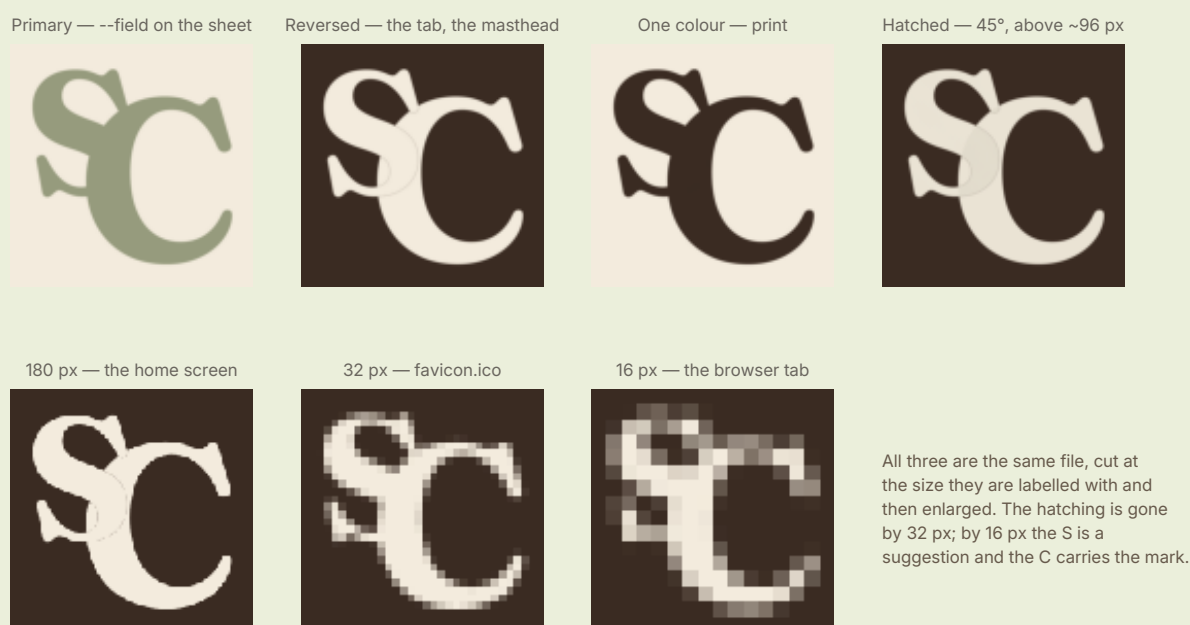


Figure 9: The interim construction: an SC cut from Fraunces outlines, in the four renderings the sheet's variation set asks for, and at the three sizes that decide whether a mark works. Superseded by the artwork; kept because the size argument survived it.

2.4.6 What it deliberately does not do

- **It spends no accent.** Sanguine is reserved for calls to action. Nothing in the artwork is sanguine, and nothing has been tinted to make it so.
- **It has no per-locale variant,** by construction, for the reason in Section 2.4.1: the same file, byte for byte, on both homepages.
- **It contributes no accessible name.** In the masthead the mark is an `<img>` with an *empty alt* inside the wordmark link, so the link's name is the gallery's name and nothing else — 2.5.3 Label in Name, and 2.4.4.

- **It is not cleaned up.** No tracing, no background removal, no contrast boost, no redrawing of the construction lines. `scripts/build-icons.py` is asserted to do nothing but crop, resize and save.

2.4.7 Where it is used

The icon set — `icon-32.png`, `favicon.ico`, the 180 px home-screen icon and the manifest; `logo-mark.png` in the masthead, where the mark and the name are a single link and a single tab stop; and this document, in the footer of every page. All from `brand/mark-lockup.png`, by one crop.

The sheet's **horizontal lockup** was tried on this document's title page and taken off again, which is worth recording because it puts a number on open item 7. The lockup is **279 px** wide in the supply. At the 52 mm a title page wants it, that is **136 dpi**, and its wordmark's capitals are about 2 mm tall — type at 136 dpi is visibly soft in print, and this report is going to be printed properly. The monogram survives the same test easily (256 px at 8.8 mm is 738 dpi) and Fraunces is an outline at any size, so the title page carries the monogram with the name set beside it, exactly as the site's masthead does. Nothing about that is a preference; it is the resolution ceiling, met.

Nine assertions in `scripts/check-review.mjs` (F-01 to F-04) hold it together: that both originals are present and byte-for-byte the files that were supplied; that every derivative is a crop and a resize of the lockup and of nothing else, with no drawing, tracing or recolouring in the builder; that the masthead carries the artwork at a declared size and mounted as a plate; that the mark takes no accessible name of its own and is identical in both locales; that nothing the site builds redraws it; that the costs in Section 2.4.4 are still stated rather than quietly absorbed; and that this section still quotes the sheet's own values rather than paraphrasing them.

2.5 Softness

The site as first built was correct and a little hard: square sheet, flat works, a colour swap for a hover and hard stops where sections met. This pass asked for something softer and more elegant — without making it less professional, and without changing a single colour.

Those two constraints do most of the design work. Every familiar softening technique reaches for new colour (a white card, a black shadow, a coloured glow) or for lower contrast (translucency), and this site has already argued, with measurements, against both.

2.5.1 What limits it

Three commitments made earlier in this document bound what "soft" may mean here.

- **Quietness is bought with size and whitespace, never with contrast.** Anything translucent puts text over a ground that is no longer a token, so its contrast has to be measured against the worst thing that can pass beneath it — which, on a site of paintings, is white.
- **Edges dissolve rather than rule** (Section 2.6). A softer site should have *fewer* lines, not decorative new ones.

- **A painting is never altered.** Rounding its corner crops it. Zooming it on hover implies it was cropped to fit. Stretching it misrepresents the object for sale.

Motion has its own limit, already recorded in the stylesheet: many viewport-heights of large images make scroll-triggered movement a vestibular risk, and every animation must stand down when the reader has asked for reduced motion.

2.5.2 Research notes

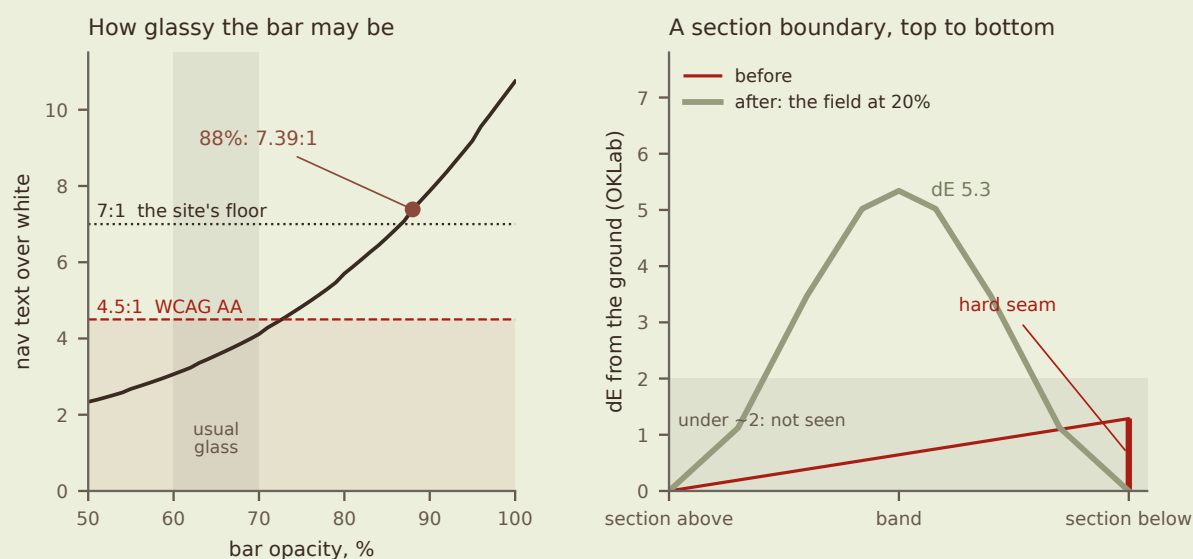


Figure 10: Left: how translucent the masthead may be, measured as navigation text over a white passage of a painting. Right: the lightness of a section boundary from top to bottom, before and after. Both panels are computed from the live token file.

Glass has a hard floor, and it is high. The usual glassmorphism panel runs at 60–70% opacity. Over a white passage that puts the navigation at 3.06–4.11:1: a failure at caption size. WCAG's 4.5:1 is reached at 73%; a full AAA margin of 7:1 needs 87%. The glass that is legal here is subtle by necessity, and the right-hand side of Figure 10 is why it is still worth having: a painting passing under a solid bar is cut off by a slab, while under 88% it is *felt* as a soft blur of its own colour.

Glass at rest would repaint the brand. Prototyping showed a problem no contrast figure reveals: a translucent bar at the top of the page sits over the sage, so every page would show a greyed, greenish masthead instead of Priscilla's brown. Glass is only wanted once there is something beneath it.

A boundary between near-identical washes is invisible and hard at once. The washes differ by ΔE 0.8–2.6 in OKLab — at or under the threshold of perception when spread across 9 rem — so a boundary is only ever seen where it breaks: a band that fades to the wrong neighbour, or a section with no band at all, leaves a hard step that reads as a faint line. A band must fade between the grounds actually either side of it, and be visible enough to be felt.

A peak reads as a crease. A boundary that rises and falls through a few evenly weighted stops draws a pointed profile, and the eye finds the point. The adopted band follows a raised cosine across nine stops, which is what the right-hand panel of Figure 10 plots — read back out of the stylesheet rather than redrawn.

Motion on this site must settle, not perform. The motion tokens already say *leave quickly, settle slowly, never overshoot*. Cross-document view transitions let a painting carry from the list into its own page. They need a unique name per element on each page; two elements sharing a name abort the whole transition, which rules out naming the lightbox copy.

2.5.3 Options

Every option considered is listed. **Adopted** items are built. **Optional** items remain available for a later pass, and where one fails a measured limit the reason says so.

Table 8: Softness options, by area

Area	Option	Status	Why
Edges	2 px on controls and panels, 3 px on the sheet	Adopted	Softens the pixel-hard corner without changing shape; a mount board is square
Edges	8–16 px radii	Optional	Reads as an app, not a gallery
Edges	Rounded corners on the paintings	Optional — <i>crops the work</i>	Rounding a corner removes part of the object being sold
Elevation	Three-layer shadows tinted with <code>--bar</code>	Adopted	A brown shadow sits <i>in</i> the paper; a black one sits on it and reads grey
Elevation	Single large neutral shadow	Optional	Reads as a glow
Margins	Passe-partout: a <code>--paper-deep</code> mat, no outline	Adopted	What a gallery does to a work; defined by tone and shadow, not a line
Margins	<code>--paper</code> mat with a hairline	Optional	Crisper and more card-like, but adds the line the site avoids
Margins	Shadow only, no mat	Optional	Softer still; loses the mounted look
Margins	Sheet floating from 900 px, not 1320 px	Adopted	On a 1280 px laptop the sheet used to run into the bar
Glass	Masthead at 88%, scroll-driven, desktop	Adopted	7.39:1 over white; solid at rest; nothing passes under it on a phone
Glass	Masthead at 60–70%	Optional — <i>fails 4.5:1</i>	3.06–4.11:1 over a white passage

Area	Option	Status	Why
Glass	Translucent reading panels over the sage	Optional — <i>unbounded contrast</i>	The sheet is the reading surface; text on glass over a painting has no worst case to solve against
Glass	Footer at 88% over the field	Adopted (18 Sep)	Behind it is the sage, not a painting, so the worst case is one computable colour: 8.96:1
Glass	Frosted plates on the sheet, at 72%	Adopted (18 Sep)	Cream over cream: the composite is always lighter than the wash beneath, so it cannot make any text worse
Field	A fall from a lifted --field to --field-deep	Adopted (18 Sep)	The largest solid on the site, and the only surface with nothing happening in it. Carries no text at any width
Boundaries	The field breathing through each band at 20%	Adopted	ΔE 5.3: plainly there when scrolling, a fifth of the way to the sage
Boundaries	Bands named by, and fading between, their actual neighbours	Adopted	No hard step where a band meets the section beside it
Boundaries	Each section its own sheet, with sage between	Optional	The most emphatic; replaces one mounted sheet with several and doubles the shadows
Boundaries	The mark set small at the centre of a band	Optional	A signpost that repeats the logo on every scroll
Boundaries	A hairline or short sanguine rule	Optional — <i>adds a line and spends the accent</i>	Contradicts both principles above
Motion	Nav underline drawn in from the left	Adopted	A transform, so nothing reflows and the 48 px target is unchanged
Motion	One-pixel button lift, pointer devices only	Adopted	On touch, :hover sticks after a tap
Motion	Mount shadow deepens when a work is hovered	Adopted	Elevation without touching the painting
Motion	Lightbox fades and settles 8 px	Adopted	No scale: a painting drawn at 99.5% is drawn wrong
Motion	Zoom a painting on hover	Optional — <i>alters the work</i>	Implies cropping; no hover on touch
Motion	Scroll-triggered reveals, parallax	Optional — <i>vestibular risk</i>	Also invisible in a link-card thumbnail and the first frame

Area	Option	Status	Why
Motion	Animated focus ring	Optional — <i>not recommended</i>	A focus indicator must be present the instant focus arrives
Navigation	Masthead held still across page changes	Adopted	Without it the whole bar dissolves and re-forms, which reads as a reload
Navigation	The painting carried from list to page	Adopted	Chromium and Safari; elsewhere navigation is simply instant
Navigation	Smooth scrolling for in-page jumps	Optional	A long glide past many large images; already declined

2.5.4 What was built

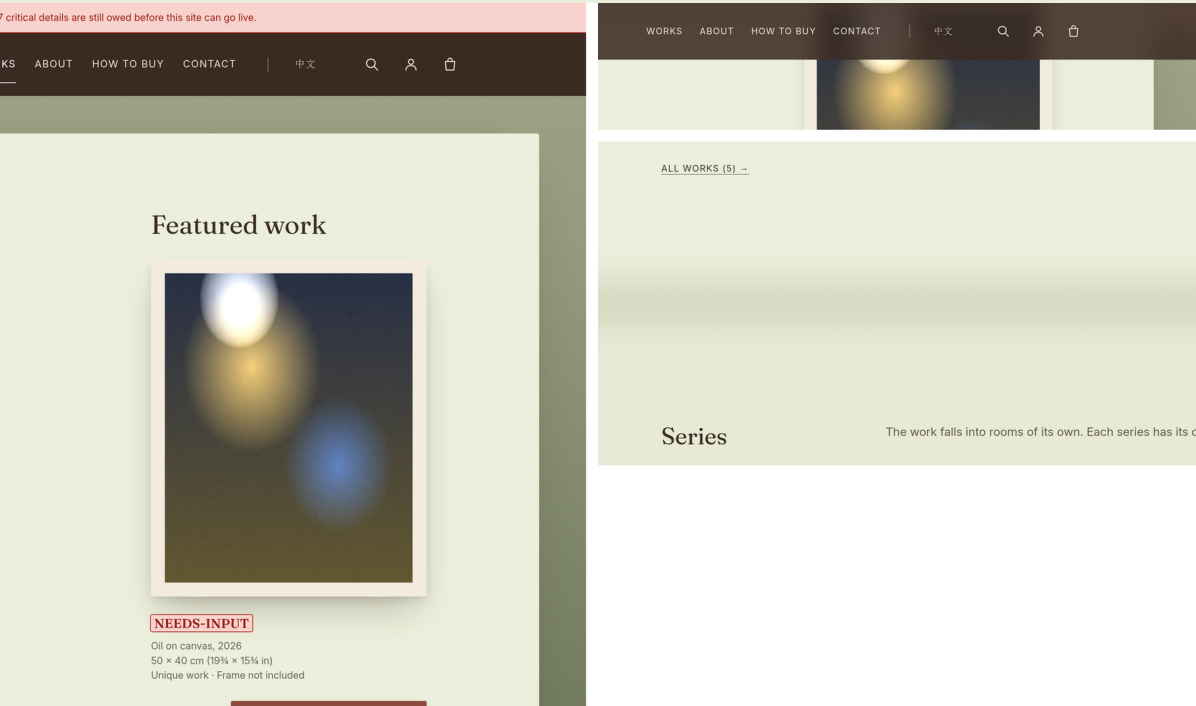


Figure 11: The adopted treatment, with a synthetic stand-in canvas in place of photography that does not exist yet. Left: hover — the navigation underline drawn, the mount lifted, the button raised one pixel. Top right: the glass bar at its scrolled state, with the canvas’s near-white highlight beneath it. Bottom right: the homepage boundary between Latest works and Series.

Nothing in the palette changed. Every softness token — two radii, three shadows, the mat, the glass values and the boundary breath — is expressed through colours that already existed, and a check fails the build if a literal colour appears among them.

2.5.5 The glass, extended

A second pass on 18 September took the same treatment to the three surfaces the first one left flat, on the same terms: **nothing is translucent over a ground whose colour cannot be named.**

- **The field.** The sage ran as one fill from edge to edge — the largest solid on the site. It keeps its colour and gains a slow fall from a lifted `--field` at the top to `--field-deep` at the foot, fixed rather than scrolling, so the sheet reads as mounted on a ground that is lit. Both ends are palette values, and no text sits on the field at any width, so none of it is a contrast question.
- **The footer.** It runs the bar's own glass at 88%. Where the masthead's worst case has to be *assumed* — a painting can put pure white under it — the footer's is a single computable colour, because what is behind it is the field. That composite is written down as `--glass-footer #45382D`, and `check-contrast.mjs` recomputes it from `--bar`, `--glass-bar-opacity` and `--field` on every run and fails on any drift. Footer text measures **8.96:1** on it, and the contact details EU and Chinese law require to be published are the text in question.
- **Plates on the sheet.** The contact panel is now a frosted plate rather than a second ground stamped on the first. The safety argument is arithmetic: `--wash-lift` is lighter than every reading ground, so 72% of it over `--wash-deep` — the darkest of the three — composites to `#EBEFDD`, *lighter* than `--wash-deep`. A plate can only make the ground under text paler than the one already solved against, never darker.

So that a rule can say what it is really read on, a stylesheet rule may now declare a `--contrast-ground`. The check prefers it over whatever background the rule also paints, which is how a surface painted in a `color-mix()` the script cannot composite still gets solved against a real colour. The footer, the legal declaration and the channel row all declare one.

2.5.6 The canvas

The brief for this pass was the texture in the artwork, and not one colour with it. So the texture was **measured off the artwork** rather than chosen: a 300 px patch of blank ground in `brand/mark-lockup.png` has a mean of `#E4DCCC` and a luminance standard deviation of **4.87 of 255**, about 2.2 %, and its spatial spectrum falls off as $1/f$ with no periodic peak. That last detail settles what it is. A woven canvas has a weave, and a weave shows as a peak; this is a **cold-press cotton-rag sheet** — paper fibre, not cloth. What the tile ended up on is a mat board, which is the same material by another name.

One tile in `tokens.css` reproduces it: `feTurbulence`, desaturated, its output compressed to a narrow band about 0.5, tiled at 400 px. Getting the *character* right took as much measuring as getting the amplitude right — the first tile matched σ almost exactly and still read as a fine woven mesh rather than as paper, because a high octave count on an anisotropic base frequency makes `feTurbulence`'s own lattice visible. Six candidates were rendered beside a 1:1 crop of the artwork and compared; what the paper has is broad, cloudy low-frequency mottle with a faint tooth over it, which is a low base frequency and many octaves. Measured back out of Chrome on the built page, the field reads at σ **4.77** against the artwork's 4.87.

Why it cannot change a colour, and why that needed measuring

The tile is neutral grey with a mean of exactly 0.5, and it is composited in `soft-light`. Soft-light with a 0.5 source is the **identity** — $B(C_b, 0.5) = C_b$ — so the mean of a textured surface is the token it was painted with, and the grain only modulates around it. Measured, the largest mean drift on any ground is **0.9 of 255**, or 0.35 %.

That is true only because the filter declares `color-interpolation-filters="sRGB"`. Without it SVG filters run in `linearRGB`, `feTurbulence`'s 0.5 mean arrives as **0.73** in `sRGB`, and the tile that was supposed to be an identity lightens everything it touches. The first render did exactly that, and it was caught by measuring the result rather than by reading the specification — which is the same lesson as Section 2.2.3, in a different currency.

Where it may go was decided twice, and the second answer is the short one: **one material**. The tile is on the mat around a painting and on nothing else.

It was on three things — the field, the bands between sections, and the mat — and both of the others came off on 20 September 2026, each for its own reason and neither of them a matter of taste.

The **field** came off because it is the largest surface on the site, which made the grain most of what you saw rather than something you found. Nothing was lost in colour: the tile is mean-neutral under soft-light, so the field was never anything but `--field` either way. The brief for it was one line — *revert the sage backgrounds to the uncanvassed version, as in the original prototype* — and that is what the field is now: her flat green, lit from a raised `--field` at the top to `--field-deep` at the foot.

The **bands** came off because the reason they had it turned out not to be true. A band carried the same tile at 30 % as a *dither*, on the assumption that a nine-rem fade in eight bits must step visibly. Measured at 1× over the built page, with the intended ramp subtracted so that only the error remains:

Table 9: What the dither was actually doing to a section boundary

Band, 144 px tall	Row-mean residual	Peak excursion
with the tile at 30 %	0.195 of 255	3.69
without it	0.173 of 255	1.04

Banding is a *horizontal stripe*, so the row-mean residual is the thing that measures it — and it is **lower without the tile than with it**. The browser dithers the gradient itself; the tile was adding per-pixel noise and no smoothness. The band's whole range is 19 of 255 over 144 px, about 21 levels, so even an engine that does not dither steps one level at a time across seven rows.

What is left is a rule about material rather than about arithmetic, and that is a change worth naming. The arithmetic used to bind: `check-contrast.mjs` solves how far a mean-neutral grain could move each reading ground before its tightest pair fell through its floor, and on cream the answer was nearly nothing. On the sage grounds it is no longer the constraint

Table 10: How much texture each reading ground could take

Ground	The tightest pair on it	Room either side of 0.5	The tile needs
--wash-pale	--muted-ui at 3.27:1	± 0.283	± 0.250
--wash-mid	--muted-ui at 3.15:1	± 0.126	± 0.250
--wash-deep	--muted-ui at 3.06:1	± 0.052	± 0.250

— the palest reading ground could now carry the whole tile and be measurably fine. It does not get it, because it is a wall and not a board. The check still fails the build if any rule ever paints a reading ground *and* textures it, and `check-review.mjs` G-07 asserts the narrower rule by name: the textured selectors are the mat and the video's mat, and there are two of them.

This document is no longer printed on it. Every page of this report used to be --wash-warm carrying the same tile, on the argument that it was the site's own paper. The site's paper is untextured now, so the argument has expired: the report is printed on --wash-pale, flat, which is exactly what the site's reading surfaces are. It also removes a 300 dpi image from underneath every page, which is one less thing between the press and the type.

2.5.7 How it is held

- `check-contrast.mjs` composites the bar at --glass-bar-opacity over pure white and fails the build below 7:1 for navigation text. Set to the usual 70%, it names three failures.
- `check-render.mjs` lays the built pages out in Chrome and asserts that every painting's box keeps the painting's own proportions to within 1%, with no radius and no transform (Section 5.4).
- Three more (G-07) cover the canvas: one tile, defined once and referenced exactly twice; the tile neutral, symmetric about 0.5, declared in sRGB and blended with soft-light; and the textured selectors exactly the two mats.
- Four more (L-01 to L-04) cover the decisions of 20 September 2026: the fifteen rules allowed to paint cream and no sixteenth; the three reading grounds all at the field's own hue and all above the lightness where --muted-ui fails; the italic a real file with synthesis off; and About set as a book page in both languages, including the two refusals on the Chinese one.
- Six assertions in `check-review.mjs` (G-01 to G-06) cover the rest: no literal colour in the new tokens — with one named exception, --glass-footer, allowed only while the contrast check recomputes it — a mat and nothing that alters a painting, glass solid at rest and gated, all new motion standing down for reduced motion, one transition name per painting per page, and every band joining the grounds actually either side of it.

2.6 The two masters

The brief asked for a debt to Leonardo and to van Gogh, carried without ever announcing itself. The test applied throughout: *a visitor who knows nothing should feel only that the site is calm and well made; a visitor who knows the work should feel recognised.*

2.6.1 What was adopted

- **The accent is sanguine.** Red chalk, the medium Leonardo drew in, measures 6.33:1 on white; the oxblood Priscilla chose by eye measures 6.68:1. They are the same colour. The recommendation was to change nothing and record why.
- **No hard edges.** Leonardo's instruction to paint "*without strokes or lines, in the manner of smoke*" and the Chinese 没骨 ("boneless") tradition of painting without contour are the same idea reached independently. For a Chinese painter addressing both audiences that is a structural principle, not a motif. Section boundaries dissolve rather than rule.
- **The rules are van Gogh's stated violet.** He told Theo the *Bedroom* walls were "of a pale violet"; they read blue today because the red lake faded. The site uses the colour he said, not the colour that survived.
- **Hatching runs his way.** Leonardo was left-handed, so his stroke runs upper-left to lower-right. No text source could be retrieved, so the 43.8° angle is an original structure-tensor measurement of his sheets, validated against a right-handed control.

2.6.2 What was cut, and why

The myth filter

Golden-ratio grid. Unsupported. Illustrating Pacioli's *De divina proportione* establishes that Leonardo drew the solids, not that he composed on the ratio.

"Leonardo invented sfumato", and the word itself. Cennino Cennini described blending shadows like smoke a century earlier, and Leonardo never used the noun — a full-text search of the *Trattato* returns none.

Any yellow as text. Indian yellow is 2.10:1 and zinc yellow 1.53:1. Both are genuine *Starry Night* pigments and both are unusable for anything but a mark inside an image.

Sampling colours off the paintings. The *Bedroom* wall as it survives today is 2.78:1; the *Sunflowers* chrome yellow 2.70:1. Both sit within a hair of the 2.67:1 failure this report opens with.

2.7 The site's structure

The first build's menu — *Original Works, Tribute, About, How to Buy* — mixed jumps down the homepage with real pages, had no page that listed the works, and could group a work only by a two-value field. None of that survives a catalogue growing past a few dozen works, or a new genre. The structure below replaced it.

2.7.1 Method

Six reference sites, chosen to cover the three models this site sits between: artists' own sites (David Hockney, Kehinde Wiley Studio), galleries (David Zwirner, Victoria Miro) and marketplaces for original work (Saatchi Art, Artfinder). Each was **rendered in headless Chrome**, not fetched as HTML: two of the six build their navigation and filters with scripts,

and a plain fetch reported Saatchi as having no filters at all. Navigation, hierarchy, breadcrumbs and side columns were read from the rendered page and checked against a screenshot. Three first choices could not be used: Gerhard Richter's site was offline, Hauser & Wirth rate-limited the request, and Artsy refused it.

Counting `<aside>` elements suggested four of the six had sidebars; every one was a region-settings pop-up, so only the rendered layout was trusted.

2.7.2 What the six agree on

Columns: **H** Hockney · **W** Kehinde Wiley · **Z** David Zwirner · **VM** Victoria Miro · **S** Saatchi Art · **A** Artfinder.

Table 11: The six reference sites, September 2026

Pattern	H	W	Z	VM	S	A	Majority
Works under one entry; no series beside About	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	6 / 6
Buying reachable from the header	—	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	5 / 6
Contact reachable from the header	✓	✓	✓	✓	—	—	4 / 6
A navigation sidebar	—	—	—	—	—	—	0 / 6
Highlights or latest in a sidebar	—	—	—	—	—	—	0 / 6
A filter sidebar	—	—	—	—	✓	✓	2 / 6
Breadcrumbs	✓	—	—	—	✓	✓	3 / 6
<i>How to buy</i> as a header page	—	—	—	—	—	—	0 / 6

Two things the table does not show. The filter sidebars both belong to marketplaces listing tens of thousands of works — Artfinder's showed *60 of 25,000*. And where an artist's own site organises a large body of work, it does it one level down: Hockney's *Works* opens onto media, and within *Paintings* a horizontal row of decades.

2.7.3 The sidebar question

No. Not for navigation, highlights or anything latest.

- **None of the six uses one for navigation or highlights.**
- **Right-hand columns are not looked at.** Eye-tracking puts desktop attention on right-rail content at 0.8% of fixations: people have learned that the side column is where advertising lives, and avoid it whatever it holds.¹
- **Local navigation is for large sections.** It earns its space when visitors browse and compare many sibling pages, and is not needed for small ones; when it is used it should be less prominent than the global navigation.²

¹Nielsen Norman Group, [Fight against "right-rail blindness" and Banner blindness revisited](#).

²Nielsen Norman Group, [Local navigation is a valuable orientation and wayfinding aid](#).

- **Filters belong beside the grid only when there are many of them.** Sidebar filters are often overlooked because they sit where navigation and banners usually are; a horizontal row above the results works for up to six to eight filter types, and a sidebar is the better choice beyond that.³

Where this site needs what a sidebar would carry, it gets it in the reading path instead: the *latest* works are a homepage section, each series is a room with its own page, and the Works section's rooms are one quiet row of tabs.

2.7.4 What was built

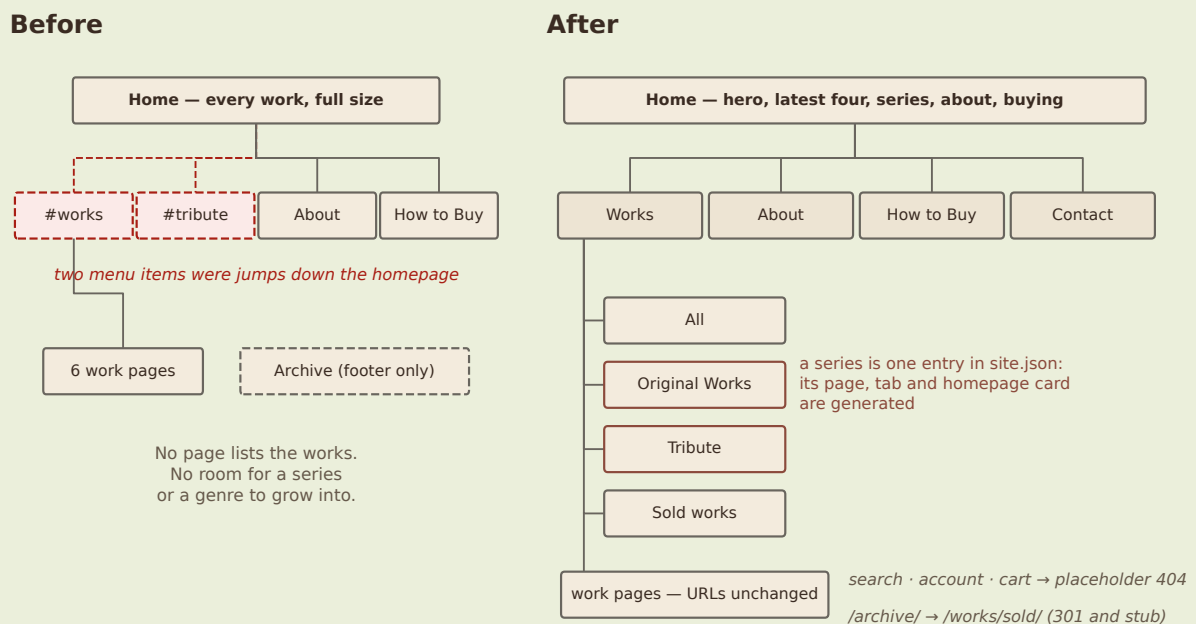


Figure 12: The site map before and after. The after tree is drawn from `site.json`, the same data the build generates the navigation and series from.

- **The header goes to four real pages:** *Works*, *About*, *How to Buy*, *Contact* (作品, 关于, 购买方式, 联系), and marks the one the visitor is in — page on the section's own page, true beneath it.
- **Works is the catalogue.** `/works/` lists every available work, newest first, with a row of tabs: *All*, *Original Works*, *Tribute*, *Sold works*, each with its count. Each series is a room at `/works/series/{id}/`; sold works moved from `/archive/` to `/works/sold/`.
- **Series are data.** A series is one entry in `site.json`; its page, its tab and its homepage card are generated from it, and the build refuses a work that names an undeclared series or genre, or a slug that would collide with a page under `/works/`.
- **The homepage is a front door, not the catalogue:** van Gogh's line — his Dutch above the reader's language — beside one *Featured work*, the four *Latest works* with a link to all of them and their number, a card for each series, About, and How to Buy.

³Baymard Institute, *Be careful with horizontal filtering toolbars*.

- **Breadcrumbs from the second level down**, with the current page as text and a work's trail running through its one series (*Home / Works / Tribute / ...*), and published as structured data. The top level has none: there is nothing above it to return to.
- **The footer carries the channels as marks.** Instagram, Facebook, X, Bluesky, 小红书 and WeChat, drawn on one 24-unit grid at one stroke weight in the footer's own colour — a set that belongs to this site rather than six logo files that belong to six other companies. Each is a 48 px target with a visually hidden name, because an icon has no accessible name of its own. A handle turns its mark into the real profile link; WeChat and 小红书, which have no address derivable from a handle, go to the contact page where the handle is printed. **Until a channel has its handle its mark still appears and links to a route that does not exist**, so the click lands on the 404 page — the same arrangement decision D1 uses for search, account and cart, and policed the same way: the route must be declared in `site.placeholders.social`, and must still be dead. Readiness rule ID-06 requires every channel to be a handle or an explicit "" before a release will build, which is what clears the placeholders by itself.
- **Nothing that was shared breaks.** Work pages keep their addresses. `/archive/` answers with a 301 on Cloudflare Pages and with a redirecting page on hosts that cannot send one.

2.7.5 Where it stays personal

The consensus decides the shape; the site keeps its own character inside it.

- **Tribute keeps its room.** The van Gogh epigraph and the hatch texture that marked its homepage section now mark its series page — the room it belongs in — and it has a card of its own on the homepage.
- **The front door keeps the gallery's voice:** the motto in two languages and one painting, and the sfumato bands between sections, each still joining the grounds either side of it.
- **One departure from the six.** None of them puts *How to Buy* in the header, and here it stays there. The six either take cards through an ordinary checkout or sell to collectors who expect to enquire. This site sells across a border, without cards, with import duty the buyer has to anticipate, and with its cart still a placeholder; how buying works is a question a visitor has before they have chosen anything. When the cart works, *How to Buy* moves to the footer and the cart becomes the header's way in to buying — as five of the six have it.

2.7.6 How it grows

The depth is fixed at three levels below the homepage — *Works / series / work* — because more than a few levels is where visitors lose their way;⁴ growth is added across, not down.

⁴Nielsen Norman Group, *Flat vs. deep website hierarchies*.

Table 12: Growth rules

When	Then
A new series is added	One entry in <code>site.json</code> ; page, tab and card follow. Asserted (I-03)
Genres come into use: two or more among available works	A horizontal genre filter row on <code>/works/</code> . A genre is a filter, never a fourth level: a landscape in <i>Tribute</i> is in one room and matches two filters ⁵
The Works tabs pass eight, or filter types pass eight	The Works navigation moves to a left column on desktop — the one case the research supports a sidebar. The eight-tab ceiling is asserted today (I-06), so the change cannot happen by accident
More than six series	The homepage shows six series cards and a link to all
About gains pages — CV, exhibitions, press	About gets its own row of tabs, as Works has
The cart takes payments	<i>How to Buy</i> leaves the header for the footer

2.7.7 How it is held

Assertions I-01 to I-06: the header links to four real pages and marks the current one; every work is listed exactly once — on *Works*, on its series page, or among sold works; the homepage shows at most four and states how many there are; a series needs only data; deeper pages carry a breadcrumb whose last step is the page itself; the old address still arrives; and no navigation lives in a side column. The render check covers the catalogue, both series pages and sold works.

2.8 The site as built

Six captures of the preview build, five on a desktop and one on a phone. They are not mockups: `docs/report/shots.sh` takes them from `dist/` each time this document is built, so they show the site as it is. The ribbon across the top of each page and the red NEEDS-INPUT flags are the preview's; a release has neither (Section 5.5).

2.9 The design review

The built site was reviewed in September as a designer rather than as its author. Nineteen findings, in five groups; eighteen were implemented, and each is held by an assertion of the same number in `check-review.mjs`.

⁵Nielsen Norman Group, [Polyhierarchies improve findability for ambiguous IA categories](#).

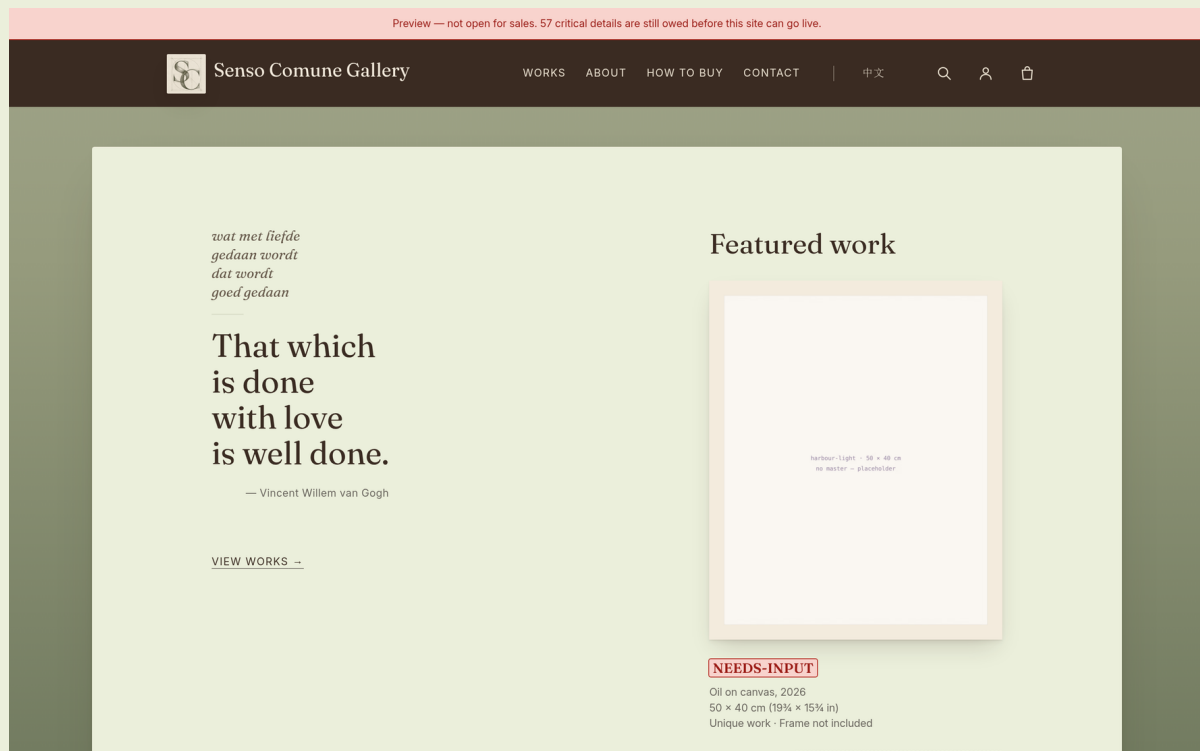


Figure 13: The homepage. A pale sage sheet mounted on the sage field, with cream kept for the mat around the work, dark brown bar, the SC monogram at the head of the wordmark, and search, account and cart at the right. Van Gogh's line stands twice: his Dutch from letter 143 to Theo — *wat met liefde gedaan wordt dat wordt goed gedaan* — set small and italic above the reader's own language, with his full name beneath, aligned to the quote's longest line. Beside it, the featured work; on a phone the quote leads and the work follows.

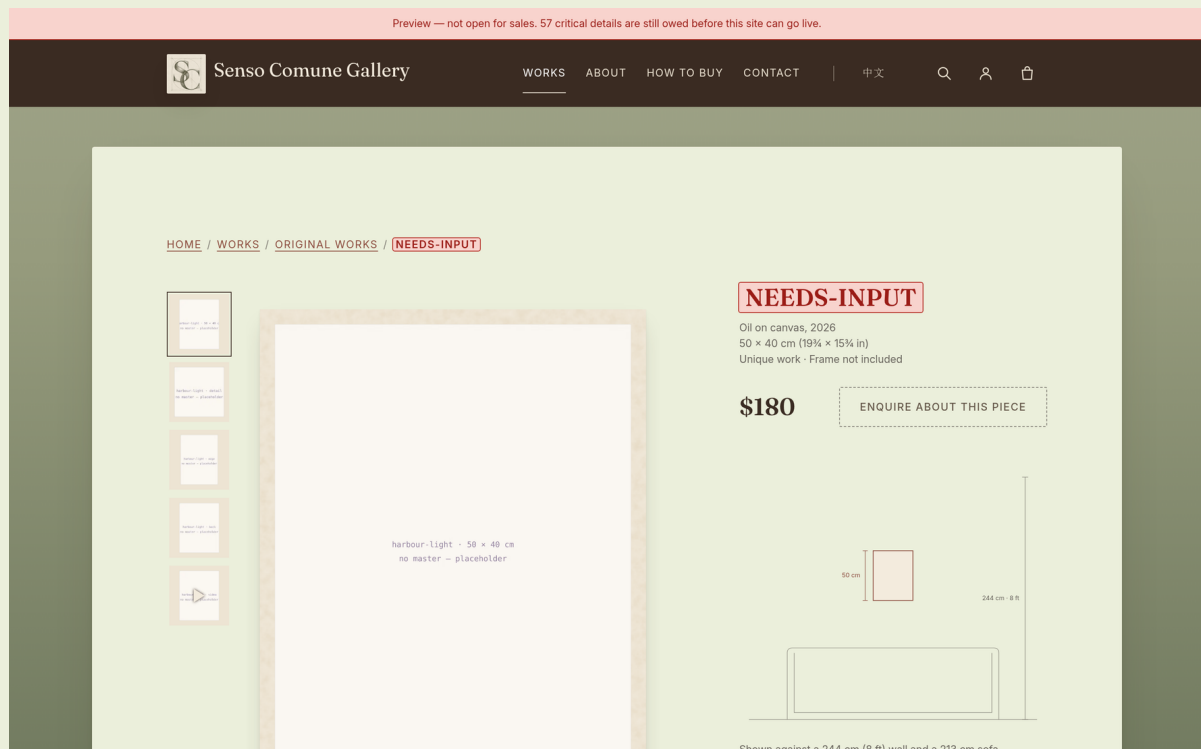


Figure 14: A work page. The views of the work — front, detail, edge, back and video — sit in a strip with thumbnails always visible, grey placeholders until the photographs exist. The price is the boldest element in the block. The scale diagram shows the painting against a 244 cm wall and a 213 cm sofa, hung at the museum standard of 144.78 cm, which is also where the mark's datum sits.

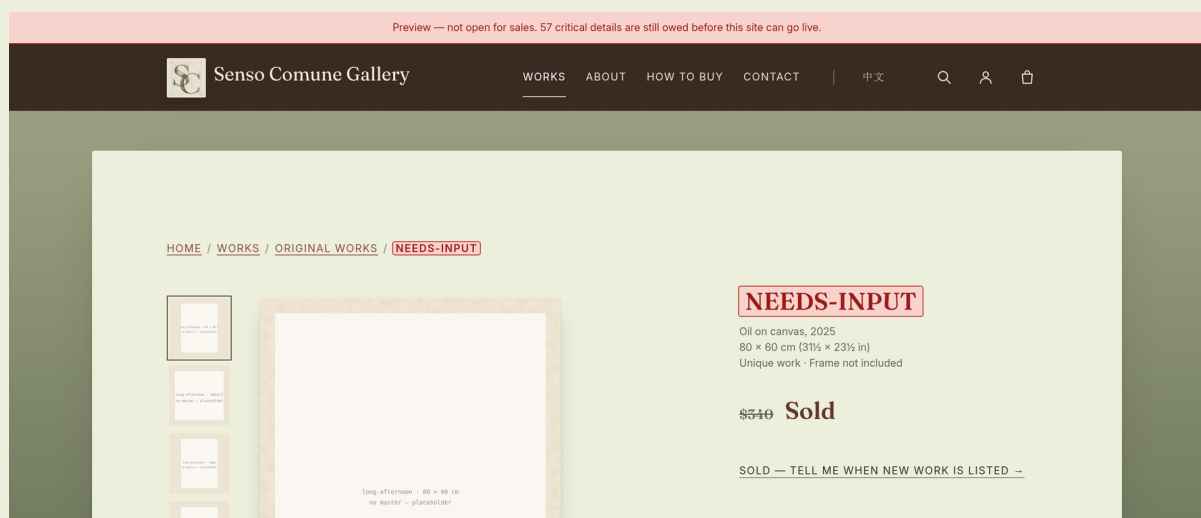


Figure 15: The sold state. The price stays visible as social proof, "Sold" sits at full contrast in the price position, and the call-to-action slot becomes a capture rather than a dead end.

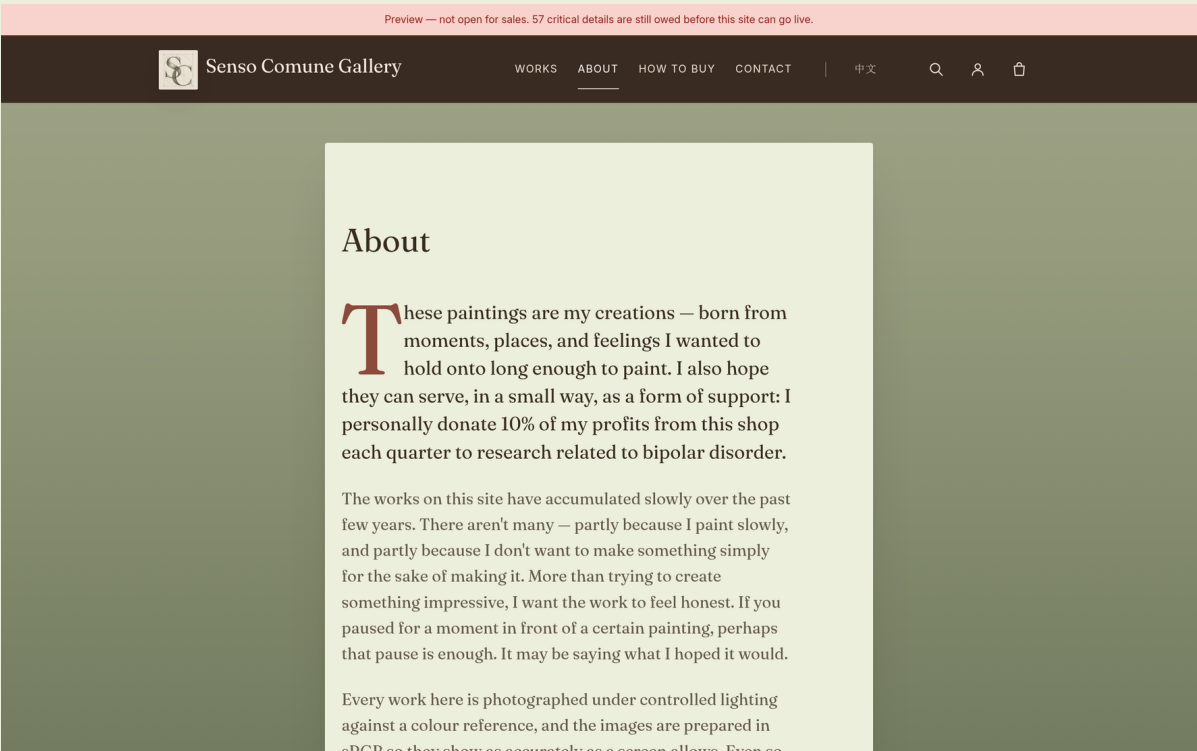


Figure 16: About, set as a book page: the display face at 19.2 px, a lede, a three-line drop cap in sanguine, and the closing quotation in Fraunces’ real italic. The mount comes in to 660 px around a 34 rem column. The Chinese page is the same page in a system serif, without the drop cap or the italic (Section 2.3.2).

Table 13: What the review changed, by group

Group	No.	What shipped
A Selling	4	A painting moved into the hero beside the motto; a <code>mailto:</code> link stopped calling itself <i>Buy</i> ; How to Buy gained reachable contact details; the price and its button were bound into one block
B Contrast and craft	4	A footer grey at 2.34:1 — shipped, not theoretical — was removed; the contrast checker was taught to resolve the cascade rather than read declarations; the scale diagram’s linework went from 1.73:1 to 3.24:1 and its labels from 3.05:1 to 4.90:1
C Reach	4	The icon set, <code>theme-color</code> and manifest (Section 2.4); Open Graph typed as a product with price and availability; the sage field restored on a phone
D Reading	5	Prose pages given a narrower mount; the archive set as a grid rather than a second selling gallery; the gallery name made the <code>h1</code> ; dead rules deleted
E Fonts	2	The Chinese subset’s coverage is now asserted at build time, and each locale preloads only the face it uses



Figure 17: The homepage on a 390 px phone. The masthead takes two rows — the short name and the shop bar, then the sections and the language switch — and does not stick: a sticky masthead that tall would take a third of the screen and hide the focused item. Van Gogh's line comes before the featured work.

Two were not fixes. **C-04** proposed freezing the wordmark in English; it was declined, and the wordmark still translates. That decision is what later freed the logo: a monogram is a device beside a name rather than a translation of one, which is why an SC mark can stand beside 常识画廊 (Section 2.4). And half of **B-03** was wrong: the scale diagram's painting and sofa were said to be off-axis, and are centred. Its contrast half was real, and is the measurement above.

Re-checked on 18 September against the review as written: all nineteen are accounted for. Eighteen shipped and every one of them is green in `check-review.mjs` under its own number; C-04 is recorded there as decided rather than done. **One part of one finding is still open** — A-02 asked for a WeChat route for the `zh` locale alongside the enquiry button, and the QR image that needs does not exist yet. The contact details it depends on are owed too (Section 5.5.4), so it is on the list in Section 7.2 rather than forgotten.

PART 3

Money

3.1 Paying

3.1.1 The constraint

Stripe is not available

Mainland China is absent from Stripe's supported business countries. Hong Kong, Singapore and Japan are present. This is not the narrower finding about PayPal — it is the whole account.

Airwallex looked like the answer and is more restricted than it appears. A mainland entity can open an account for Global Accounts, foreign exchange and transfers, but card acquiring is excluded in Airwallex's own Chinese-language terms, and it opens no personal accounts at all.

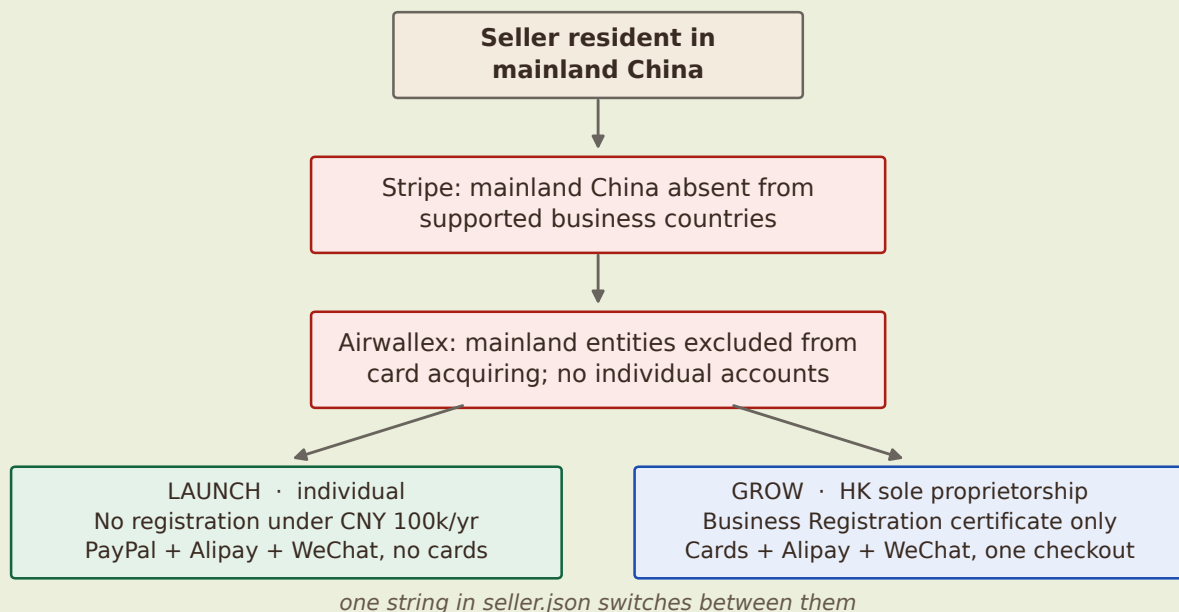


Figure 18: The two routes, and the one string that switches between them.

3.1.2 Route A — launch as an individual

At this turnover, four obligations that would normally apply do not.

Table 14: What the individual route does not require

Requirement	Position	Authority
Business registration	Not required under CNY 100,000/yr online turnover	SAMR Order 37, Art. 8 ¶13
FX annual quota	Not consumed — cross-border e-commerce settles outside it	汇发〔2020〕14号 Art. 66(2)
BOP declaration	Not filed — resident individuals exempt at or below USD 10,000 per transaction	汇发〔2022〕22号 Art. 8
VAT	Exempt — monthly sales under CNY 100,000, to 31 Dec 2027	财政部/税务总局 2023 年第 19 号

Six works at \$60–\$440 is roughly CNY 19,000 — an order of magnitude below the registration ceiling.

What Priscilla must not do

Route sale proceeds as a gift or family remittance; split transactions to stay under a threshold; or use informal currency swaps. The last is 私自买卖外汇 under Article 45 of the FX Regulations, and published enforcement puts the penalty on the offender's PBOC credit file.

3.1.3 Route B — a Hong Kong sole proprietorship

A Business Registration certificate is sufficient — no incorporation. That unlocks the free Airwallex plan with no-code payment links, international cards at 3.60% + HK\$2.35, **and Alipay and WeChat Pay** as merchant methods, which is how the domestic half of the audience is served from one checkout.

It also unlocks repatriation: Airwallex supports local CNY transfer for sellers without a mainland registered business whose ultimate beneficial owner is a Chinese national exporting goods from the mainland. That describes this business exactly.

Confirm before incorporating

Airwallex approves its Payments product **separately** from account opening, and reviews the live site as part of that review. The entity list verified covers account opening only.

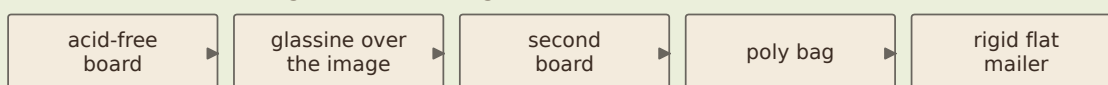
3.1.4 Rejected

Payoneer Checkout is Stripe-powered, excludes mainland China explicitly, and requires monthly volumes above USD 20,000 — roughly 130× this business. **PingPong** and **Lian-Lian** both have real independent-site acquiring, but neither publishes pricing or eligibility and both are sales-led. Do not design around either without a written quote.

3.2 Shipping

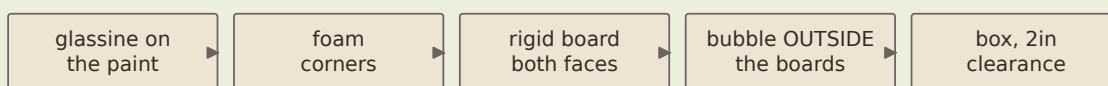
Works on paper

flat, never rolled — rolling cracks the sizing



Stretched canvas

upright, never flat — and never below freezing



Materials run \$25–50 per shipment. Every carrier's artwork declared-value cap sits above this inventory.

Figure 19: How each kind of work travels. The paper rule is the one most often got wrong.

Works on paper ship flat, never rolled

Rolling cracks the paper's sizing and can crease or smear the media. Tubes are a fallback for very large **unstretched** canvas only.

Stretched canvas ships upright, never flat, with the bubble wrap outside the rigid boards so nothing touches the paint. Cold is a real hazard: linseed oil stiffens and can crack below freezing, which matters for winter shipping.

The much-discussed "\$1,000 artwork cap" does not bind here. FedEx caps declared value on art at \$1,000 or \$9.07/lb, whichever is greater; USPS additional insurance for artwork caps around \$1,000. Every one of those caps sits above this entire inventory.

3.3 Duty and tax at the border

The site cannot say "duty-free" to US buyers

Original paintings under HS 9701 carry a **Free** base rate, which is where the belief comes from. For a **China-origin** shipment in 2026 it is wrong.

- **Section 301 List 4A applies.** HTSUS 9903.88.15 imposes **+7.5%** on products of China, and US note 20(s)(i) enumerates 9701.91.00 — contemporary paintings — among the covered subheadings. The exclusion that once covered paintings is expired.
- **De minimis is suspended.** The \$800 exemption no longer applies, so every painting needs a customs entry.
- **The IEEPA tariffs are gone** — struck down and revoked in February 2026 — and artworks were separately carved out of them as "informational materials". That relief does **not** extend to Section 301.

A \$300 painting, China origin, delivered to the United States



Figure 20: What a US buyer actually pays on a \$300 painting.

Table 15: Import treatment by destination

Destination	Duty	VAT / tax	Confidence
United States	+7.5% Section 301	—	Verified
United Kingdom	0% , ERGA OMNES (origin-neutral)	Reduced art rate	Verified
European Union	0% expected	Reduced art rate per member state	Unverified — see Section 7

3.4 The donation pledge

The draft said "10% of each order goes toward research", which is a per-transaction consumer promise. The site now says *"I personally donate 10% of my profits each quarter"* — a personal pledge, which is a materially different representation.

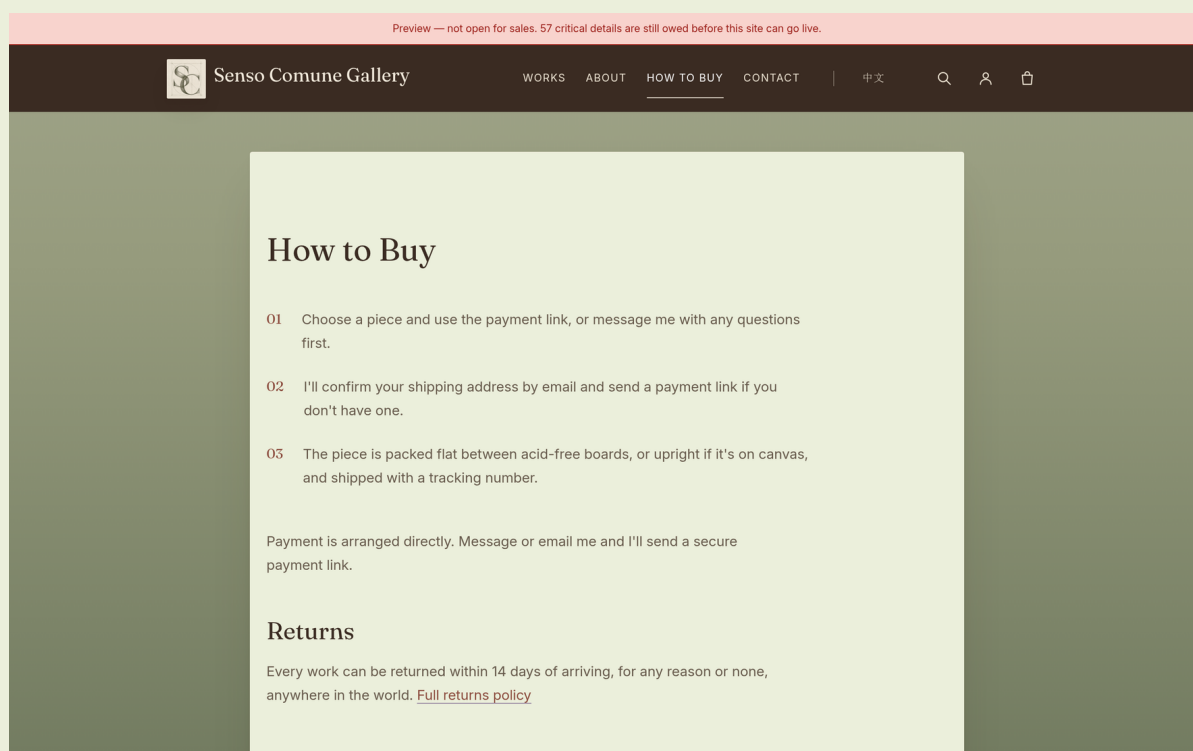


Figure 21: The How to Buy page, which puts the duty figure in front of the buyer before they commit rather than after.

What protects the pledge is not the wording but the receipts: a public page with the recipient named, the basis stated, the cadence disclosed, and a running cumulative total.

PART 4

Law and access

4.1 Returns

Returns cannot be refused, in either market

China. Consumer Protection Law Art. 25 gives a seven-day no-reason return on distance sales. The exceptions are a **closed list** — SAIC Order 90 Art. 6 excludes only goods made to the consumer's order, perishables, unsealed digital media and delivered periodicals. The 2024 Implementing Regulations Art. 19 then expressly forbid a trader expanding that list, and ban pre-ticked exclusion.

European Union. CRD Art. 16(c) excepts goods "made to the consumer's specifications or clearly personalised". **Uniqueness is not personalisation** — the test is whether the *buyer* specified it. A pre-existing painting chosen from a catalogue fails that test.

A "governed by PRC law" clause does not help: Rome I Art. 6(2) prevents a choice of law from depriving a consumer of protections that cannot be derogated from under their home law, where the trader directs activity there. Offering EU shipping at checkout is directing activity.

One worldwide 14-day policy over-satisfies the Chinese seven days, removes any need to geo-detect buyers, and avoids a seven-day policy reading as an attempt to shorten the EU right. Commissions are the one genuine exception under both regimes.

4.2 Disclosure

One block of address, phone and email satisfies three regimes at once: the EU Consumer Rights Directive Art. 6(1)(c), the Chinese requirement, and the UK anticipatory duty. Alongside it, SAMR Order 37 Art. 12 prescribes the exact sentence an unregistered individual seller must publish:

个人从事零星小额交易活动，依法不需要办理市场主体登记

That string is quoted verbatim from the rule and must not be paraphrased.

4.3 Privacy

PIPL applies, and costs a privacy page and a one-page impact assessment — no more. Processing necessary to conclude and perform the sale needs **no consent checkbox** — a just-in-time notice at the email field is the correct pattern, and consent is reserved for the newsletter. No PRC representative and no regulator filing are required, because those provisions bind handlers *outside* China. The overseas hosting is exempt from the CAC transfer mechanisms both as contract-necessary and on volume.

4.4 Accessibility

4.4.1 The legal position

Calmer than the compliance industry suggests. A one-person operation is almost certainly exempt from the European Accessibility Act as a microenterprise providing services. The stronger argument for the work is commercial: **a blind collector who cannot read the descriptions cannot buy the painting.**

4.4.2 What was built

Table 16: Accessibility work, by criterion

Criterion	What it required	Status
1.4.3 Contrast	Every CTA was 2.67:1	Filled ink control at 11.45:1
1.4.1 Use of colour	No accent reaches 3:1 against body text	Underlines on body links, structurally
2.4.7 / 1.4.11 Focus	A single-colour ring dies over a dark painting	Two-tone ring, works on any ground
2.4.11 Focus not obscured	Sticky nav can hide the focused item	<code>scroll-padding-top</code> ; static on mobile
2.5.8 Target size	Nav bars are not sentences; the inline exception does not apply	48 px via padding
1.1.1 Non-text content	Six paintings, no alt text	Three-layer description per work
2.4.4 Link purpose	Six identical "Buy" links in the links list	Visually-hidden span per control

4.4.3 Describing a painting

The "125-character limit" is folklore — there is none in the HTML specification or in WCAG. The citable number is Cooper Hewitt's **approximately fifteen words**.

The guidance genuinely disagrees on interpretation: the DIAGRAM Center says never interpret, Cooper Hewitt says interpret when it aids visual understanding. For an artist's own gallery Cooper Hewitt is right — but interpretation stays textually separable, labelled "Artist's note", placed last, and never allowed to replace observation.

On AI-drafted descriptions

Acceptable as a first pass, never as shipped text. A model can report palette, format and apparent handling. It cannot know the true medium, the real dimensions, the title, or the intent — which is exactly what a buyer needs. A wrong description is worse than none, because it burns trust in the channel.

PART 5

The build

5.1 Shape

Plain Node, no framework. Thirty-six pages generated from three data files, with **one npm dependency** — *sharp*, and only for turning photographs into web derivatives — which is the only architecture consistent with a design whose argument is restraint. Generating the pages needs Node and nothing else.

Three other things in this repository do need Python, and say so rather than pretending otherwise: the icon build, the image tool (Section 5.1.1) and this document. All three want Pillow; the report also wants matplotlib, fontTools and CairoSVG, and the image tool's trace mode wants VTracer. None of them is needed to build or check the site, with one exception noted in Section 5.4.

```
src/data/          site.json · seller.json · artworks.json
                  readiness-waivers.json      signed exceptions to the gate
src/styles/        tokens.css · base.css · gallery.css
src/scripts/       gallery.js                  the work-page views, enhanced
src/templates.js
build.js           36 pages, two locales, and the 404
brand/            mark-lockup.png              the artwork, as supplied, and
                  brand-sheet.png             the sheet it came on
scripts/          build-icons.py              the icon set, cut from it
                  image.py                    vectorize · rasterize · selftest
                  mark.mjs · mark-paths.js     the interim construction, now
                                          drawn only by this report
                  build-fonts · build-fonts-cjk · build-images · build-icons
                  readiness · check-readiness · test-readiness · release
                  check-contrast · check-links · check-review · check-render
                  preview.mjs                  one page, inlined, for review
docs/             brief/ · report/
```

The page count follows the data: eighteen pages per locale for six works in two series, of which six are work pages.

5.1.1 Converting between a drawing and pixels

`scripts/image.py` (`npm run image`) is the one place the project converts between the two, in both directions, and it states what each conversion costs instead of choosing quietly:

Mode	What you get
pixel	True vector geometry — every decoded pixel as an integer-aligned rectangle, horizontal runs merged. No quantization, smoothing, denoising, recolouring or resampling, and no compression either: large, and exact
embed	The original file, byte for byte, inside an SVG <code><image></code> . Visually lossless and honest about being a raster in a vector wrapper
trace	VTracer infers regions and paths. Compact, and an approximation — which is what <code>--verify</code> is for
rasterize	SVG or SVGZ back to a raster at a stated size, optionally flattened onto a colour, because alpha is the commonest thing to lose by accident

The output format is chosen by the **extension**, so the name of a file and its contents cannot disagree: `.svg .svgz .pdf .ps .eps` on the vector side, `.png .webp .jpg .tif` on the raster side. The geometry is always built as SVG; PDF, PS and EPS are that SVG handed to Cairo, which is a container change and not a second approximation. Two things follow and are said rather than discovered: the `<metadata>` audit block only survives in the SVG containers, because PDF and PostScript have nowhere to keep it, and a pixel-mode page of a million rectangles is a million rectangles in PDF too — for print, `trace` or `embed` is almost always what is wanted. A format that cannot carry alpha, such as JPEG, refuses an image that has some until `--on` says what it should sit on.

The input file is never written to, and every output carries a `<metadata>` block naming its source, that source's SHA-256 and the mode, so a derived file can always be traced back. `--verify` renders the result back at native size and reports per-channel error, composited over black and over white as well as raw, because a renderer may legitimately rewrite RGB wherever alpha is low.

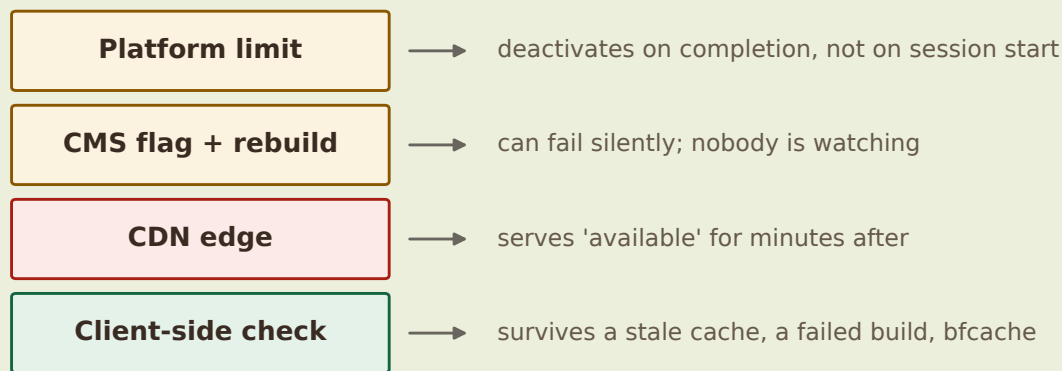
It has a `selftest`, and `npm run check` runs it: two fixtures — flat runs, a single pixel against a run, and partial alpha — both directions, requiring byte-exactness when the source is opaque and one unit per channel when it is not. A tool nobody re-tests is a tool that quietly stops working before the day somebody needs it.

5.2 The entity switch

One string in `seller.json` moves the whole site between the two commercial routes:

```
"activeEntity": "individual" → "hk-sole-prop"
```

That switches the published legal disclosure, the invoicing language, the checkout provider and the returns basis together. No template knows which entity is active.



No platform in this price range guarantees atomicity. The bottom layer is the cheapest, and the only one that survives the other three failing.

Figure 22: Defence in depth. Each layer above the bottom one fails in a way the bottom one survives.

5.3 Overselling

No platform in this price range guarantees atomicity. The client-side availability check is roughly forty lines and is the only layer that survives a stale CDN page, a silently failed rebuild or a bfcache restore.

Alongside it, a published policy costs nothing and settles the residual case: *in the rare event two people buy the same piece at once, the first completed payment stands and the second is refunded in full within 24 hours.*

5.4 Checks that block the build

`npm run check` runs the first four in seconds. The rendering check needs Chrome; GitHub runs it on every preview, and the release runs all of them.

One of the four reaches outside Node: `check-review` ends by running the image tool's own selftest, which is Python. That was a deliberate choice over letting it skip when Python is bare — a check that can quietly not run is not a check — and the CI workflow installs the four wheels it needs so that it always does.

Table 17: The checks

Check	What fails it
check-contrast	Any token below its floor on the darkest ground it is painted on — resolving the cascade, so the declaration that actually wins is the one measured — and the glass bar under 7:1 over white
check-links	A dead link; missing <code>alt</code> , <code>width</code> or <code>height</code> ; heading order; landmarks; <code>hreflang</code> ; a Chinese character the font subset does not cover; a placeholder route that resolves. In a release, any <code>NEEDS-INPUT</code> or placeholder at all
check-review	78 assertions over 52 findings — the design review, the mark, softness, the shop bar and views, the structure, the flags and the gate — written against the built pages, so a fix that stops being applied fails the build
test-readiness	Any of 44 tests showing the gate opens only when it should (Section 5.5.3)
check-review, last assertion	The image tool failing its own round-trip: two fixtures, both directions, byte-exact when the source is opaque and within one unit per channel when it is not (Section 5.1.1)
check-render	In Chrome, at 1440, 900, 390, 360 and 320 px across 12 pages: a painting out of its own proportions, rounded or transformed; a masthead that overflows, takes more than two rows or has a control under 44 px; either half of van Gogh's line re-wrapped, its attribution off the quote's edge, or the featured work ahead of the quote

Headless Chrome will not lay a page out narrower than 500 px — asked for 390, it lays out at 500 and crops. Phone widths are therefore laid out inside an `iframe` of exactly that width, with scrollbars hidden, and the check asserts the width the page actually received.

A test that passes for the wrong reason

One of the review fixes `set font-size:var(--size-h1)`. No such token exists — the scale calls it `--size-hero` — so the rule silently fell back to inherited body size, and the assertion written for it passed because it only matched the declaration's text. The repair was a cross-cutting assertion that every `var(--token)` in the shipped stylesheet resolves to a definition. An undefined custom property is the one CSS error that produces no error.

The limit of automation

Automated testing decides roughly 13–30% of WCAG success criteria and catches almost none of the focus-order and focus-visibility failures that block people outright. The checks are a floor, not a pass.

5.5 Readiness

The site must not go live until every critical detail is supplied. A list of fields marked NEEDS-INPUT is not enough to ensure that: an empty email, `test@example.com` or a placeholder photograph contains no such word, and a list that is printed does not stop a build that is published. The readiness gate checks what is in each field, and a release cannot be built while it is closed.

5.5.1 What the research says

- **Fail closed.** When a control cannot establish that it is safe to proceed, it should stop rather than carry on — the security principle usually called *failing securely*.⁶ For this site the unsafe state is a shop that looks open and is not lawful or not honest.
- **The law names what is critical.** For distance sales to EU consumers, the trader's identity, geographical address, telephone number and email, the main characteristics of the goods, the total price and the arrangements for payment must all be given.⁷ China's E-Commerce Law requires the business licence information — or the statement that registration is not required — to be shown continuously in a prominent place on the homepage.⁸
- **Validate values, not words.** A real email address is best checked against the definition every browser uses, a deliberate, practical subset of RFC 5322.⁹ Some names are reserved precisely so they can never be real — `example.com`, `.test`, `.invalid`¹⁰ — which makes an address on one an example nobody replaced. A telephone number in international form has a country code and at most fifteen digits.¹¹ A WeChat ID is six to twenty letters, digits, underscores or hyphens, beginning with a letter.¹²
- **Gates must be visible.** A documented case from this month: a Cloudflare Pages production build failed, the previous version kept being served, and every check on the repository stayed green, so nobody knew.¹³ A gate on the host alone is necessary and not sufficient.

5.5.2 How it works

- **A rules engine over the data** (`scripts/readiness.mjs`): 26 rules, each with an area, a severity, the condition under which it applies, the fix, and the law or finding it rests on. It reads nothing and writes nothing, so the build, the report and the tests ask the same question.
- **Values, with the word as backstop.** Every critical field has a rule that checks what is in it; a final rule catches NEEDS-INPUT, *TODO*, *lorem ipsum* and the like anywhere no specific rule reaches, and reports only what no other rule already has.

⁶OWASP, [Fail securely](#).

⁷Directive 2011/83/EU on consumer rights, [Article 6\(1\)](#), points (a), (b), (c), (e) and (g); [Article 9\(1\)](#) for the 14-day withdrawal period.

⁸《中华人民共和国电子商务法》, [第十五条](#).

⁹WHATWG HTML Standard, [valid e-mail address](#).

¹⁰[RFC 2606](#), Reserved Top Level DNS Names; see also [RFC 6761](#).

¹¹ITU-T Recommendation [E.164](#).

¹²WeChat Help Center, [How do I set my WeChat ID?](#)

¹³[tallyfy/documentation #242](#): the pipeline stays green when the Cloudflare Pages build that publishes the site fails.

- **Conditions.** Hong Kong registration numbers apply only while that entity is active; the transaction ceiling only once the cart takes payments; a donation recipient only while the pledge is above zero. A conditional rule *owns* its fields, so the backstop cannot block on a field its rule has deliberately set aside.
- **Undecided is not declined.** An optional channel is either a handle or "", which removes it from the site. Left as `NEEDS-INPUT` it is undecided, and blocks.
- **Preview by default; release by request.** Any build not explicitly a release is a preview: noindex on every page, a ribbon saying it is not open for sales and how many details are owed, and — while anything is owed — purchase controls that are drawn but cannot be used. A release asks the gate before building and again inside the build, which refuses *before* clearing the previous output.
- **Nothing of the preview survives a release.** In release mode the link check fails on a single `NEEDS-INPUT` anywhere — attributes and structured data included — on any placeholder photograph, video or asset, on the ribbon, and on any unusable button. Views without photographs are left out rather than shown.
- **Waivers with an expiry.** A blocker that can wait may be waived with a reason, a name and a date; expired or unsigned waivers do not count, and every live one is printed in every report and written into the release. Identity, the registration disclosure, returns, prices, dimensions, photographs and payment links cannot be waived — a waiver naming one keeps the gate shut. That includes the Chinese registration declaration, which must match the rule's wording character for character (rule LG-01).
- **Loud where it matters.** The production host's build command is the release script, so a closed gate is never published; a *Release check* workflow runs the same script on GitHub and fails red with the report on the run's summary page, and the preview workflow shows the report on every run.

Table 18: The rules, by area

Area	Rules	Examples of what blocks
Identity and contact	6	An email on a reserved domain; a phone number without country code; an address in one language; a malformed WeChat ID; an optional channel left undecided
Legal	4	The SAMR declaration edited by a single character; the Hong Kong entity active without its numbers; returns under 14 days; a pledge with no recipient
The site	2	An <code>example</code> or <code>http</code> site address; a header control that leads to the 404
Works and prices	7	No work for sale; a title as <i>TODO</i> ; alt text as an ellipsis; a price of 0; a currency that is not ISO 4217; a work dated next year; a payment link over <code>http</code>
Photography	3	A work for sale still showing its placeholder; a real view photograph with no description
Payments	3	No way to pay on the active entity; a live cart with no transaction ceiling
Backstop	1	A placeholder in any field no rule names

5.5.3 How it is proved

- **The gate opens when it should.** A copy of the data with every critical detail supplied passes; 32 single breakages each close it on the named rule; five waiver cases — valid, expired, unsigned, scoped to another field, and aimed at a rule that cannot be waived — each behave as specified. 44 tests, in `npm run check`; weakening the 14-day rule or the reserved-domain list turns them red.
- **End to end, on completed data.** With the fields temporarily supplied and the three header placeholders waived, the release ran: 0 blockers, 36 pages, no `NEEDS-INPUT` anywhere, no ribbon, all 40 purchase controls live, views without photographs omitted, the three waivers written into `readiness.json`, and every check green in release mode. The real data was then restored.
- **It refuses on today's data** — exit 1 at the readiness step — and assertion K-03 checks on every run that a refused release leaves the last built site untouched.

5.5.4 Today

The gate reports **57 blockers**: 36 in the works (titles, alt text and descriptions, in two languages), 5 photographs, 10 identity and contact details, the site's real address, the donation recipient, and the three header placeholders. Most are typing. One is a decision: search, account and cart block a release until those pages exist, or until someone signs a waiver for them.

`npm run readiness` prints the list, each with the field, what is wrong, how to fix it and why it matters. On the preview, every placeholder a reader can see is also flagged in red on its own pale ground, and the flag goes the moment the field is filled; placeholders inside alt text, page titles and link previews cannot carry a flag and are on the printed list instead.

PART 6

The work page and the shop bar

Two requests, researched together because they meet on the same page: a work page that gives a visitor *enough views* of a painting, modelled on three reference shops, and the *search · account · cart* trio that sits top-right on nearly every shop. Five decisions were taken on 17 September 2026 (Section 6.4). The views and the shop bar are built; the buy box, and the cart, search and account behind the shop bar, are specified and not yet built (Section 6.6).

6.1 What the reference shops do

Table 19: Three reference work pages, as they stood in September 2026

	+ART Gallery (Shopify)	Saatchi Art	National Gallery of Art shop
Gallery	Left thumbnail rail: four stills and a fifth with a media badge	Left thumbnail rail: the work, a detail, two views in a furnished room	One image, no thumbnails
Size cues	Dimensions in the details	Dimensions; room views; web AR	Dimensions in the description
Buy box	Title, vendor, price with tax line; quantity stepper; add to cart; one-click wallet	Title, artist, medium, size, "ships in a tube"; price; instalments; add to cart; make an offer	Title, SKU, price; add to cart
Assurance	Payment-method badges; accordions for shipping, delivery, contact	Shipping included; 14-day guarantee; review score	None beyond price and tax
Pressure	"Hurry, only 1 left" bar	None visible	None
Share	Facebook, X, Pinterest	Favourite count; add to collection	Facebook, X, Pinterest
Header	Search field, log in, cart with count	Search, log in / register, cart with count	Search, log in, bag with subtotal

Saatchi's is the closest model for a painter: it is the only one whose thumbnails answer the question a buyer of a unique object actually has — *what will this look like on my wall?*

6.2 What the research says

Thumbnails, always. Every desktop site in Baymard's benchmark shows thumbnails for additional images; 76% of mobile sites do not. Where only dot indicators are shown, half of desktop test users had difficulty finding the additional images, and users missed the one that would have answered their question. On mobile, a partly visible last thumbnail signals that more exist.¹⁴

At least one image in scale. 42% of users try to judge a product's size from its images, and 28% of sites give them nothing to judge by.¹⁵ For a painting sold unframed, whose size is its single most consequential property after the image itself, this is the finding that matters most.

Different images answer different questions. Product-page guidance commonly separates a plain view, an in-scale view, a close-up of material and texture, and a view in use. For a painting those become: the front, a raking-light detail, the edge and back, and the work at true size on a wall.

No auto-rotation, and real controls. The W3C pattern for a carousel requires a stop control whenever slides rotate on their own, stops rotation on focus and hover, and prefers a tab-style picker when slides are chosen directly — which is what a thumbnail rail is.¹⁶

Icons need words. Only the house, the printer and the magnifying glass are close to universally recognised; everything else — a person, a bag, a heart — is ambiguous without a visible label, and a label shown only on hover does not exist on a phone.¹⁷

Search should be as prominent as search is useful. Where people browse visually — Baymard's examples are apparel and home décor, and art is the same kind of purchase — a small search control is right; dominant search fields belong to large catalogues bought by specification.¹⁸

Urgency must be true. EU law treats falsely claiming limited availability to rush a decision as unfair in all circumstances.¹⁹ A unique work is available once, so a scarcity bar would not be false here — but the page already says *Unique work*, and a "Hurry" is pressure the brief rules out.

6.3 What is different here

A shop template assumes multiple units of many products, an account system and one checkout for everything in the cart. None of those is true of this site yet.

- **Every work is unique.** A quantity stepper has one legal value. "Only 1 left" is permanently true.
- **The catalogue is small.** Search earns its place only by finding what a visitor would actually type — a title, a medium, a year, a series — in either language, and nothing else.

¹⁴Baymard Institute, *Always use thumbnails to represent additional product images*.

¹⁵Baymard Institute, *Provide at least one "in scale" image*.

¹⁶W3C, *ARIA Authoring Practices Guide: Carousel pattern*.

¹⁷Nielsen Norman Group, *Icon usability*.

¹⁸Baymard Institute, *E-commerce search field design and its implications*.

¹⁹Directive 2005/29/EC, Annex I, point 7.

- **There is no server.** The site is static by design. Accounts need authentication, password recovery and storage of personal data — which makes Priscilla a data controller under both PIPL and GDPR (Section 4.3) for nothing the buying path requires. The payment provider already holds the buyer's record.
- **There is no multi-item checkout yet.** On the launch route each work has its own payment link, or is sold by enquiry. Whether a provider on either route can take several works in one hosted checkout is **not established** (Table 24).
- **A cart widens the overselling window.** Section 5.3 defends a unique work from being sold twice. A cart invites a buyer to believe a work is held while it sits there, and every layer of that defence has to re-check it.

6.4 The decisions

Table 20: The decisions of 17 September 2026

#	Decided	What it means
D1	Search, account and cart in the header now	Each leads to a placeholder route that lands on the 404 until its page is built
D2	Detail, edge, back and video views on every work	Placeholders until the photographs and video exist. The scale diagram stays beside the work rather than becoming a generated view
D3	Any number of works in one order	Limited only by availability and by the payment route's largest single transaction
D4	No search threshold	Search appears regardless of catalogue size, provided the query and the searchable text are correctly scoped
D5	Video on work pages only	Nowhere else on the site carries video

6.5 What is built

Figure 14 shows the result on a desktop.

- **The shop bar.** Search, account and cart on every page, in both languages, as icons whose accessible names are the words (*Search, Account, Cart*; 搜索, 账户, 购物车). Each destination is a declared placeholder, and `check-links` fails the build if one ever resolves — so a page cannot be built without its placeholder being retired in the same change. On a phone the masthead takes two rows: the short name, *Senso Comune*, with the three icons; then the sections and the language switch. Below 360 px the name is kept for screen readers and the mark alone leads home.
- **Icons only, at every width.** The research above favours visible words; the reference Priscilla chose shows icons alone, and that is what was built. Only the magnifying glass is close to universal. If the account or cart icon proves ambiguous in use, the labels are one CSS change away: the words are already in the markup.

- **A bilingual 404.** Every placeholder lands on it: both languages, no canonical, not indexed, not in the sitemap.
- **The five views.** Front, detail, edge, back and video on every work page, in a scroll-snap strip that swipes natively, with thumbnails always visible — a rail from 900 px, a row below that. It works with no script. A small script adds what links cannot: the current thumbnail marked for screen readers, no history entry per thumbnail, arrow keys, Home and End, and a video that pauses when it leaves the strip. Video is never preloaded and never plays by itself. Only the front view carries the painting between pages (Section 2.5).
- **Placeholders that step aside.** The image pipeline draws a labelled placeholder for each missing view at a sensible proportion; a real photograph replaces it on the next build and keeps its own proportions. A release leaves out any view without a photograph rather than showing its placeholder.

6.6 Still to build

Each item names the evidence that closes it; *done* means the check exists and passes, not that the page looks right. Sizes: S is under a day, M a few days, L a week or more.

6.6.1 The buy box and disclosures

- **Assurance from data, not copy.** Three lines under the action, each true and each already argued in this document: the worldwide 14-day return (Section 4.1); how the work is packed and insured (Section 3.2); and a link that estimates import duty for the buyer's country (Section 3.3) — which none of the reference shops offer, and which is the question an international buyer of a \$300 painting actually has.
- **Disclosures as native accordions:** Details, Shipping and packaging, Duty and import, Returns, Contact. No script, keyboard-operable, readable with styles off.
- **Payment methods from the active entity.** On the launch route that is PayPal, Alipay and WeChat Pay and *no card marks*. A card logo shown by a seller that cannot take cards is a misleading claim, so the list is generated, like the rest of the entity switch (Section 5.2).
- **Sharing that works in China.** The device's own share sheet where the browser has one, and *Copy link* everywhere — not Facebook, X and Pinterest buttons, all unreachable in mainland China. WeChat builds its own link card from the Open Graph tags the site already publishes.

Table 21: The buy box, item by item

Work	Done when	Size
Reorder the aside: price, action, assurance	The price is still the boldest element	S
Assurance lines generated from <code>seller.json</code>	No assurance string typed into a template	S
Duty estimate linked by destination	Every destination in Table 15 reachable	M
<details> disclosures	Operable by keyboard; content present with styles off	S
Payment methods from the active entity	Built with <code>hk-sole-prop</code> , card marks appear; with <code>individual</code> , none	S
Share sheet with copy-link fallback	Works with the API absent; no third-party share scripts	S
More works: three available, never sold	A sold work never appears	S

6.6.2 Behind the shop bar

Each is specified in the README (*Scripting still needed*). Building one means removing its placeholder route from `site.json`, which the link check and the readiness gate both require.

Table 22: The cart, search and account

Page	Work	Done when	Size
Cart	Works gathered on the device; a total held under the entity's <code>maxTransactionUSD</code> ; <code>availability.json</code> re-checked on open and before paying; several works paid in one payment where the provider allows it, otherwise work by work	A sold work is never counted in a total; no single payment exceeds the ceiling; a work in two carts cannot be paid for twice; order confirmation and withdrawal information reviewed against Section 4.1 and Section 4.2	L
Search	An index written by the build — title, medium, year and series, in both languages — searched in the browser, by substring so Chinese needs no word segmentation	English and Chinese queries both find titles and media; nothing outside the indexed fields matches	M
Account	A server, a login, password recovery and a privacy regime, for an order history the payment provider already has	Reasonable only if the site moves to a hosted platform that supplies accounts; not scheduled	—

6.6.3 Considered, and not planned

Table 23: Reference features left out

Feature	Status	Why
A generated in-scale view	Optional	Not taken under D2; the scale diagram already does the job beside the work
Web AR on the wall	Optional — <i>later</i>	Native Android AR viewers rely on Google Play services, largely absent in mainland China; in-browser AR needs a commercial platform
Make an offer	Optional	The enquiry already does this; a form needs a back end
Quantity stepper	Not recommended	One legal value
"Hurry, only 1 left"	Not recommended	True, but pressure; <i>Unique work</i> already says it
Instalment financing	Not recommended	Neither entity route has a lending partner
Review score	Not recommended at launch	No reviews exist; inventing them is unlawful

PART 7

Open items

Seven places where what is held is thinner than the decision resting on it. Every one needs a person outside this project — a customs broker, a tax adviser, a carrier, a payment provider, whoever drew the mark — and none can be closed by writing more code.

Table 24: Unresolved, in rough order of cost if wrong

#	Item	Status	What to do
1	Cultural-relics export appraisal	Not established. Chinese government sources unreachable	Confirm a living artist's new work is not 文物 before the first export
2	EU reduced art VAT rates	Unverified. Directive (EU) 2022/542 changed art VAT from 2025	Do not publish per-country rates yet
3	Carrier costs and insurance from China	No verified figures	Needed before the shipping page is final
4	Export declaration for a \$300 painting	Not established	Also determines what supports the bank's FX check
5	Airwallex + HK sole proprietorship	Entity list verified for account opening only	Ask before incorporating
6	Several works in one payment, and the largest single transaction	Not established on either route	Ask the provider in writing before the cart is built; the figure becomes <code>maxTransactionUSD</code>
7	The mark has no vector source	The whole supply is one 1536 × 1024 raster; the monogram is about 590 px of it	Ask whoever drew it for the vector, or a much larger scan. Nothing on the site needs it — a 180 px icon and a 2× masthead mark are inside the ceiling — but a business card, a 15 mm foil stamp or a gallery window each want it, and it costs nothing to keep with the rest (Section 2.4.4)

7.1 Settled in the build

Table 25: Questions the build answered, and where

Item	Resolution	Where
CJK webfont strategy	The display face is subset to the characters that appear in headings, work titles and UI labels: 34 KB, from a 24 MB face. <code>unicode-range</code> gates the fetch, so an English page never downloads it, and a character added before the next build falls through to the system face rather than rendering as tofu. Chinese body prose is deliberately not webfont-served.	<code>scripts/build-fonts-cjk.py</code>
Leonardo's hatching angle	Recorded in the stylesheet as a measurement rather than a citation, with the caveat that two chalk sheets ran the other way	<code>src/styles/base.css</code>
Mona Lisa glaze layer count	The thickness is cited; the count is not, and the comment says why	<code>src/styles/tokens.css</code>
A mark for two languages	An SC monogram — a device beside the name rather than a translation of it — used as the drawing Priscilla supplied, one crop serving the tab, the home screen, the masthead and this document	<code>brand/</code> , <code>scripts/build-icons.py</code>
What the paper actually is	Measured off the artwork rather than chosen: 1/f spectrum, no weave periodicity, σ 4.87 of 255. A cold-press cotton-rag sheet, reproduced as one tile that cannot change a colour (Section 2.5.6)	<code>src/styles/tokens.css</code>
Converting between a drawing and pixels	One tool, both directions, the fidelity of each mode stated rather than chosen quietly, and its own selftest inside <code>npm run check</code> (Section 5.1.1)	<code>scripts/image.py</code>
Whether her sage could carry the reading after all	Yes, and the failure was one-dimensional: lightness, not hue or chroma. The three grounds keep their measured lightness and rotate onto the field's hue, which cost no foreground token and improved every pair (Section 2.2.2)	<code>src/styles/tokens.css</code>

Item	Resolution	Where
Whether a nine-rem fade needs a dither	No. Measured against the browser's own gradient dithering, the tile made the row-mean residual worse — 0.195 of 255 against 0.173 (Section 2.5.6)	src/styles/base.css
What a serif costs a page of prose	14.8 % of its reading size, if set at the sans's point size. Fraunces needs 19.2 px to match Inter's x-height at 16.8 — which is where the type scale already put it (Section 2.3.2)	src/styles/tokens.css

7.2 Content still outstanding

The 57 details in Section 5.5.4. The blocking ones that matter most are the photographs, the titles and descriptions, and the contact details — the email and phone are not optional; they are the consumer-law requirement in Section 4.2.

Three things that are not NEEDS-INPUT but are still owed:

- **The Chinese-locale enquiry route** should be WeChat rather than a `mailto:`, and that needs a QR image that does not exist yet. It is the one part of design-review finding A-02 still open (Section 2.9).
- **The social handles.** Six channels are drawn in the footer and none has an address yet, so each links to a route that does not exist and lands on the 404 page. Supplying a handle turns its mark into the real link; an explicit "" takes the channel off the site. Readiness rule ID-06 will not let a release build while any of them is undecided.
- **The mark's vector source** — open item 7 above.

Appendix: sources and method

Colour. Ratios computed with the WCAG 2 relative-luminance formula. The draft’s values were extracted from the PDF content stream rather than sampled from a render, so they are declared values. Figures in this document read the project’s live token file.

Fonts. Built with fonttools 4.59.1 from the variable originals; byte counts are measured output, not estimates.

Reachability from mainland China. Measured against a GFW measurement service, with known-blocked controls validating the method before any result was accepted.

Regulatory material. Chinese provisions read from `gov.cn` and `safe.gov.cn`; EU instruments from the Publications Office; US tariff treatment from the HTSUS and the Federal Register. Article numbers are given so each can be checked.

Layout. Verified in headless Chrome at 1440, 900, 390, 360 and 320 px, not by description; phone widths are laid out in an iframe of the stated width, because Chrome will not lay a window out below 500 px (Section 5.4). The captures in Section 2.8 are taken from `dist/` by `docs/report/shots.sh` as part of this document’s build, so they cannot show a version of the site that is no longer shipping.

If this is printed. It is meant to be, so the things a printer asks for are settled rather than left to them.

Trim	A4, 210 × 297 mm. Set in <code>preamble.tex</code> , not in the front matter — Quarto passes neither <code>papersize</code> nor its <code>geometry</code> list to this template, and the document was US Letter for its whole life while every margin in it was given in millimetres. Found by measuring the PDF
Bleed	The sage band and the page canvas both run off the edge, so trim-size artwork is not enough. <code>npm run report:print</code> writes a second file, <code>-print.pdf: 230 × 317 mm</code> , the A4 trim centred in it, the edge artwork carried 3 mm past the knife, and crop marks 3 mm outside the trim and 4 mm long
Fonts	All embedded and subset — Inter, Fraunces, Noto Serif SC and the Latin Modern the maths uses
Colour	RGB. Ask the press to convert with a stated profile rather than converting it here blind; the palette is warm brown, sage and cream, which separates without drama
Images	Every figure is 285 ppi or better at its placed size, except three, all deliberate: the prototype sheet at 247, the lockup plate at 210 and the variations panel at 273 — all three are supply-limited (Section 2.4.4, open item 7) — and the small tiles inside Figure 8 and Figure 9 at 91, which are 16 px and 32 px renderings shown enlarged, where the pixels <i>are</i> the subject
Ink	The page is tinted edge to edge. For a long run on a press that charges by coverage, <code>\canvaspaperfalse</code> in <code>preamble.tex</code> gives white pages and keeps the sage band

The paper. This document's pages are the site's own reading surface, --wash-pale, flat. They carried the site's canvas tile until 20 September 2026; the site's reading surfaces are untextured now, so this one is too (Section 2.5.6). One 300 dpi image has left the underside of every page with it.

Figure quality. Page captures are taken at 2×, resampled to 1772 px — 287 dpi where they are placed — and kept **lossless**: a screenshot is type and UI edges, and since the site acquired a texture a JPEG artefact in a capture of it cannot be told apart from the texture itself. The photographic plates — the prototype sheet, the lockup, the variations panel and the page canvas — are JPEG at quality 95 with no chroma subsampling, which is the right codec for continuous tone and visually lossless at this size.

The mark. Figure 5 and Figure 6 are `brand/brand-sheet.png` and `brand/mark-lockup.png` reproduced as supplied, and the mark in this document's footer is the same crop of the lockup that the browser tab gets — the report imports the icon build's own cropping rule rather than repeating it, so the document, the tab and the masthead cannot be three different drawings. Both originals are pinned by hash (Section 2.4.2).

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